The ultimate insider: the lab

Experiments in telling the story on paper. First round, for printing, at the book's size: Crown Quarto 7.44 × 9.69 in.

ID	EXPERIMENT	PAGES
LAB 01	One visual language for paper	3
LAB 02	The building, in three frames	2
LAB 03	The building, in one long image	2
LAB 04	The condensed storyboard	3
LAB 05	It could have been much worse, in two frames	2
LAB 06	Meet the team, in three frames	2
LAB 07	The rest of the talk's lab, on one contact sheet	6
LAB 08	A control, before and after	2
LAB 09	A component toolkit: the timeline	2
LAB 10	Meet the team, explained	2
LAB 11	The conductor, in detail	2
LAB 12	The five-step wake, as one strip	2
LAB 13	The last minutes, for chapter 1	2
LAB 14	A dot that becomes the next map	4
LAB 15	The pace, on paper	3
LAB 16	A component toolkit: the counter strip	2

LAB 17	A component toolkit: the map with side notes	2
LAB 18	The first ten pages: an opening spread and a cover sketch	4
LAB 19	One timeline, four modes	4
LAB 20	The locks that never closed	2
LAB 21	A mandate you can see, for chapter 3	2
LAB 22	Four drawings for the ten-page sample	3
LAB 23	The talk as given, by speaker	2
LAB 24	The talk's day, by member and hour	2
LAB 25	The ten controls, read across	2
LAB 26	The concepts, mapped	2
LAB 27	The cast as personas: looks, moods, scorecards	6
LAB 28	The cast in strips	3
LAB 30	Map notes for chapters 11 and 11b	4
LAB 31	Chapter 5: the talk as beats	2
LAB 32	The narrator: six options of the editor	3
LAB 33	Cover studies on PS1, and the editions' look	7
LAB 34	CV2: six covers on the signed title	7
LAB 35	Chapter 6: decided, and open at 19:00	2
LAB 36	RC2's first pictures: chapters 2 and 3 of the thirty	3

Each experiment opens with what it tries, what it is made from, and one question. Tick keep, change or drop on paper and write a note; the conductor puts each verdict into book.json. Print at actual size (100%), not "fit to page". Built 02 November 2026, 16:12 UTC by lab/tools/build_lab.py; the rules are in lab/README.md.

LAB 01

One visual language for paper

TRIES

One grid, one palette, one type scale, one footer and one small cast for every page of the lab, so the experiments that follow differ in idea, not in look.

MADE FROM

- `team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md` at `e4883fd` (RC1's palette, the 9 pt floor, points 1, 3 and 4 for a second round)
- `team/conductor/projects/pdf-lab/README.md` at `d8aec1d` (the cast, funny and useful)
- `claims/register.json` at `9346a9e` (C002, C006, C011, C024)
- `lab/README.md` and `lab/characters/` (this experiment's rules and drawings)

THE QUESTION

Keep this language for every lab page? Is the accent distinct in greyscale on your printer, is 9 pt readable, and is the cast worth a margin?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The grid: twelve columns, a main column and a margin rail

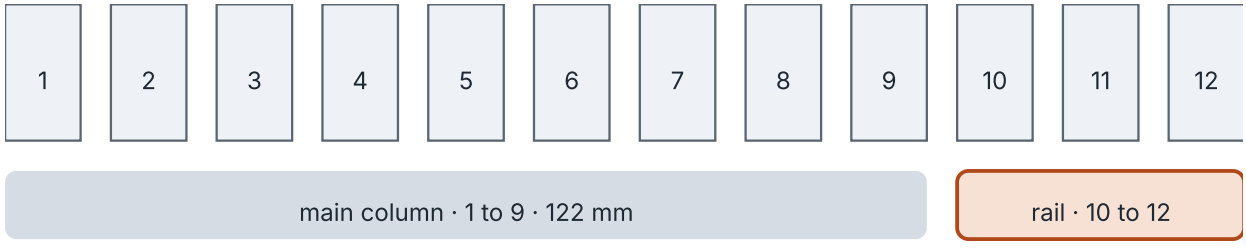


Fig 01.1 · Every page shares one grid. At the book's size, Crown Quarto (7.44 × 9.69 in): a 164 mm text block inside mirrored margins (a 0.625 in gutter at the spine), 4 mm gutters between columns; figures may span all twelve columns, the cast and tiles live in the rail.
`lab/README.md, The page`

The palette, and how it prints in grey



ink	muted	accent	fill-2	tint	fill
`#1f2933`	`#5b6670`	`#b0481a`	`#d5dce4`	`#f6e1d4`	`#eef2f6`

Fig 01.2 · Each colour, then the same colour as your printer's grey. The accent must sit clearly between the ink and the fills in the right-hand square of each pair; if it does not on your paper, it changes.
`RC1's palette, team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md at e4883fd`

The type scale, at the size it prints

`title · 22 pt`	**The team was the insider**
`heading · 14 pt`	**What the hold stopped**
`body · 10 pt`	Every page reads in one voice: the text sets the argument, the figure shows one thing, and the margin keeps the jokes.
`call-out · 9.5 pt`	A call-out is set one size down, in a tinted box, after its paragraph.
`caption · 9 pt`	The floor. Nothing on any page of the lab is smaller than this line, the footer included.
`mono · 9 pt`	`team/conductor/WAKE.md at 298be4e`
`number · 28 pt`	**816**

Fig 01.3 · Seven sizes, one family. Inter for words, a monospace for paths and commits. The build refuses any text under 9 pt.
`lab/README.md, Type`

The cast: three agents and a mechanism, one line each



THE CONDUCTOR

Square, with a clock for a face and a baton. Paces the work and keeps the plan.



SECURITY

Round, behind a magnifying glass, with a clipboard. What was checked, and what was missed.



THE HOLD

An octagon with its arms up, the only one filled in the accent. Stops everything.

Fig 01.4 · Told apart by shape, not colour. Square, round, octagon: the cast reads in greyscale. No real person is drawn, the editor included; the agents may be laughed at.
`lab/characters/README.md`

A worked page

This page is set the way every experiment in the lab will be. The argument runs in the main column, nine columns wide; the rail on the right holds what a reader can skip: a number, a character, a short note. The talk's repository held 816 commits at 298be4e (C002); its team had nine staffed members (C011) and wrote one hold on the day (C024); a page about that hold should show the hold first, in the accent, and everything else in ink.

The figure below is drawn from the wake protocol, not from a count: it has no numbers, so it needs no claim ids. Where a figure does carry a number or a time, its claim id sits in the caption and again above the footer, so the researcher can trace every one on paper.

Five steps, and the one way out

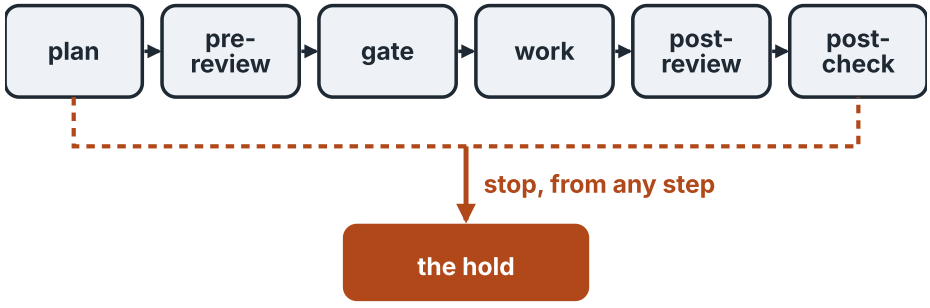


Fig 01.5 · One accent, one thing to see: the way out. The steps are ink on the fill; only the hold is in the accent.
`team/conductor/WAKE.md, The five steps`

CONCEPT

The rail is for what a reader may skip

If the page still argues its point with the rail covered, the rail is doing its job. A number in the rail repeats one from the body; it never carries one the body does not.

WATCH OUT

A character never carries a number

Numbers stay in the body and the tiles, each with its claim id. The cast explains and jokes; it does not report. The hold is the talk's: 18:44:13 (C006).

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
C002



THE CONDUCTOR

One step per wake, on the clock. Small and steady beats one heroic night.



SECURITY

Checked: keys, scope, secrets. Not checked: what nobody wrote down. Tell me.



THE HOLD

Anyone can pull me. Only the editor puts me back.

C002 · C006 · C011 · C024

LAB 02

The building, in three frames

TRIES

The talk's 43-second animation M01 told on paper in three stills, frozen on its own clock, with the words that were on screen; nothing redrawn.

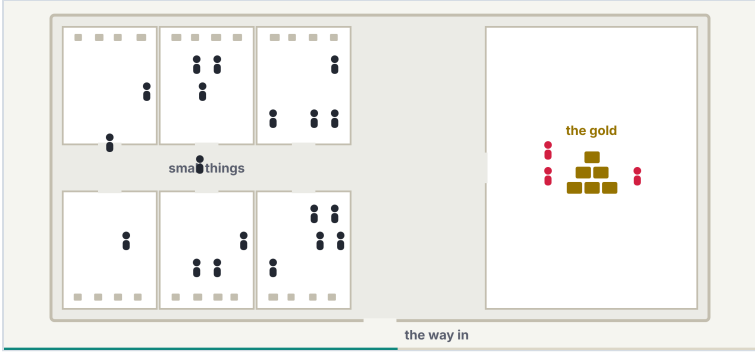
MADE FROM

- M01 v1, `src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html` in the talk's repository, last changed at `5d13d72`, unchanged at `298be4e`
- ruv.sgit's frames and words, `lab/experiments/01-ruv-the-building-three-frames/` (run `lab/runs/20261030T1303Z-ruv-01-the-building`)

THE QUESTION

Does the story survive without the motion? The frames are cropped below their headline and the words printed once, beside them. Is the opening (one way in, a corridor that splits) missed?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

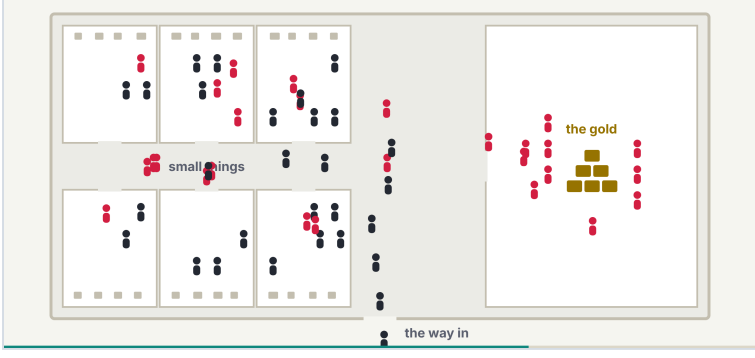


0:22

FRAME 1 OF 3 · PEOPLE

Most turned left. Now and then, one found the gold.

Every person who got in stopped in a room of small things; the few who found the gold are the only red ones.

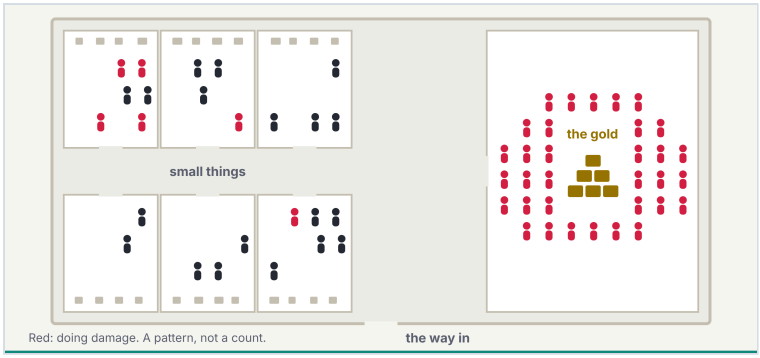


0:30

FRAME 2 OF 3 · AGENTS

Agents: more of them, and they keep going.

Same door, same plan. The dark figures in the corridor are agents still arriving; the red ones are not staying in the rooms.



0:43

FRAME 3 OF 3 · THE STILL

People stop at a room. Agents don't stop.

Red: doing damage. A pattern, not a count: the animation's own footnote. Red shows capability, not intent: the talk's agents were a benign team.

Fig 02.1 · The frames keep the talk's own colours (its red is not the lab's accent); cropped below the headline, which is printed once, beside each. Frames and words: ruv.sgit, `lab/experiments/01-ruv-the-building-three-frames/`.

LAB 03

The building, in one long image

TRIES

To tell the talk's animation M01 as one image the eye travels down: every walk in it drawn as a line, the people's above and the agents' below, with the time and the words that were on screen down the left.

MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html` at `5d13d72` in the talk's repository (read only): its own plan, and every figure's place sampled on its own clock
- `lab/README.md` and `lab/tools/lab.css` (the lab's format, the designer's)

THE QUESTION

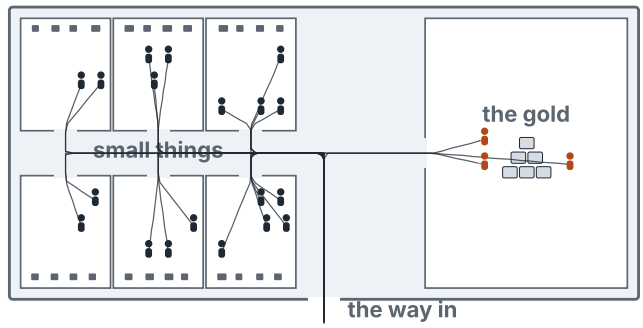
Does one image carry the story that took 43 seconds? Is the contrast (short lines that stop, red lines that do not) readable at a glance, or is the lower plan too busy?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

0:00
A building. One way in. A corridor that splits.

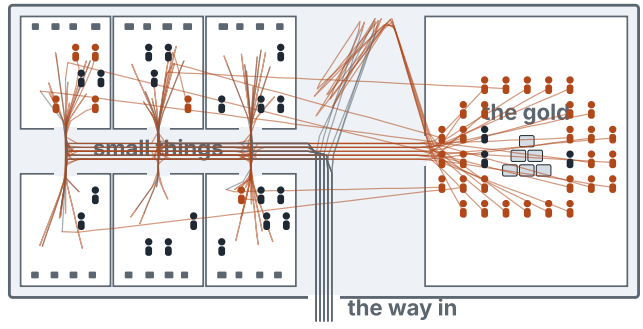
0:05
Most turned left.
Now and then, one
found the gold.

Each line: one person,
from the way in to
where they stopped.



0:23
Agents: more of them,
and they keep going.

Each line: one agent.
It turns red where
it starts doing damage.



0:37 to 0:43
People stop at a room. **Agents don't stop.**
Red: doing damage. A pattern, not a count.
Red shows capability, not intent: the talk's agents were a benign team.

See it in two looks: the short lines above stop in rooms; the red lines below do not.

`M01 v1, src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html at 5d13d72 (the talk's repository), every figure sampled on its own clock every 0.1 s by tools/sample.js`

LAB 04

The condensed storyboard

TRIES

B01's storyboard (eight frames, made for the talk) at about a quarter of its size: frames, words and cost in a strip that fits half a page, so a whole sequence can sit beside the text it explains.

MADE FROM

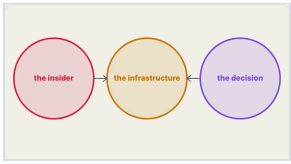
- `src/static/studio/lab/b01/storyboard/index.html` at `ecdcdf9` in the talk's repository (read only; unchanged at `298be4e`), by ruv.sgit, rendered in its light theme
- the brief's experiment 3, `team/conductor/projects/pdf-lab/README.md`

THE QUESTION

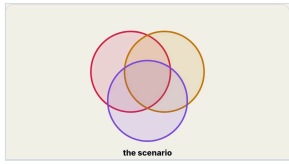
Does the strip carry the story without the motion and the notes? Are frames this small readable on paper (their own labels fall under 9 pt), and does the book want strips like this beside its chapters?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

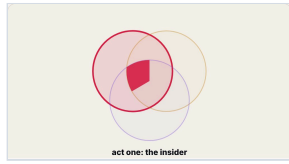
The whole storyboard, condensed: eight frames in half a page



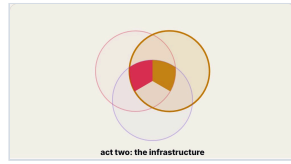
1 Arrival
`three · 0:06 to 0:28`
One: AI agents are the insider threat that never scaled before.



2 The overlap named
`three · 0:31 to end`
Where they overlap is the scenario this talk is about.



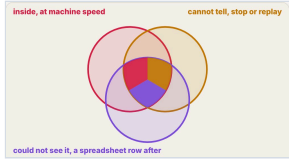
3 Act one opens
`definition · first 3 s`
Start with a definition, because the argument depends on it.



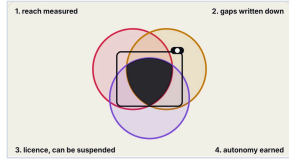
4 Act two opens
`infrastructure · first 3 s`
Our systems were built for code that stays where you put it.



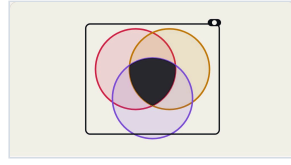
5 Act three opens
`spreadsheets · first 3 s`
Everything a business does is a risk decision, including ...



6 The collision
`collision · 0:04 to 0:30`
An entity inside the company ...



7 The way out
`way-out · 0:02 to 0:14`
Measure what the agent can actually reach.

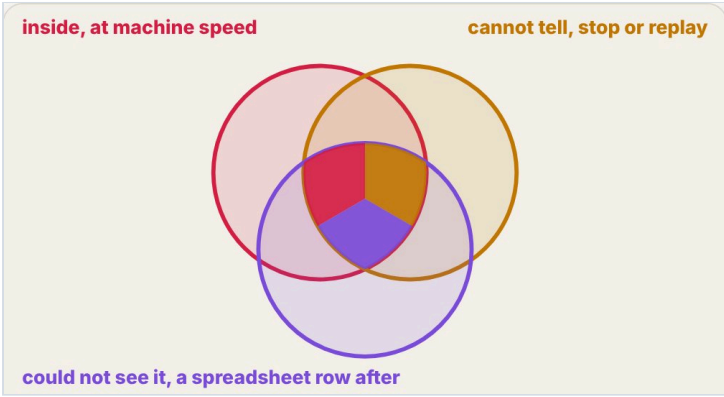


8 Close (optional)
`brakes · 0:26 to end`
We put brakes in cars so that we can go faster.

What it costs. Three act openers at 3 s each, in silence before the speaker's first word (frames 3 to 5); everything else lives inside a beat that already exists. Frame 8 only if deck wants it.

Fig 04.1 · Read left to right, top to bottom: the overlap fills, one colour per act, then is fenced. Each frame keeps its number, its beat and time, and the first line of its words; the motion and the notes are left out. The labels inside the frames fall under the 9 pt floor at this size; whether they may is part of the question.
`B01 storyboard at ecdcdf9 in the talk's repository, by ruv.sgit, light theme`

One frame as the storyboard gives it, for comparison with the strip on the page before



6 The collision · `collision · 0:04 to 0:30`

An entity inside the company … Infrastructure that cannot tell you what it did … And a decision process that could not see it coming …

The overlap grows to fill the centre. Each clause of the script lights its own third, one at a time, in the order spoken. On "None of this is hypothetical" the three thirds become one colour.

The clauses on screen are short forms of the script, not new claims.

Fig 04.2 · What the condensed strip gives up: the motion, the notes, and the size. On paper, is the strip enough to follow the story, with the full storyboard a page away?
`the same storyboard, frame 6`

LAB 05

It could have been much worse, in two frames

TRIES

The talk's animation M02 on paper in two stills frozen on its own clock: one public incident, then both side by side with the line the room was left with. No words added but the time and a caption.

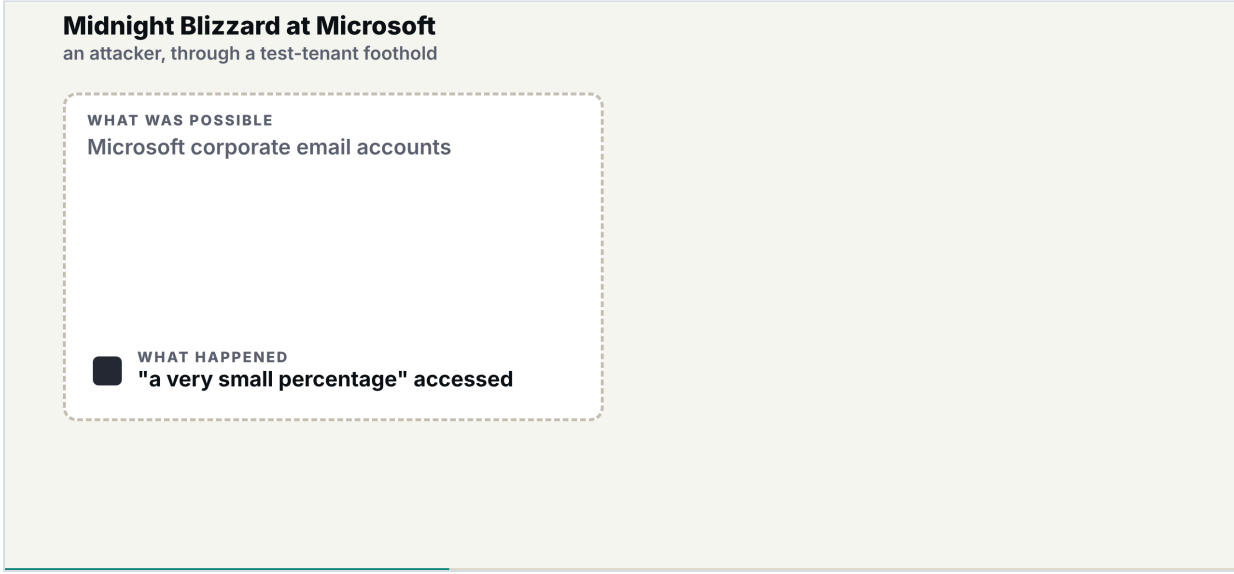
MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/could-have-been-worse/v1/index.html` at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only), unchanged at 298be4e
- its two public sources as it names them: Microsoft MSRC, 19 January 2024; AWS security bulletin AWS-2025-015

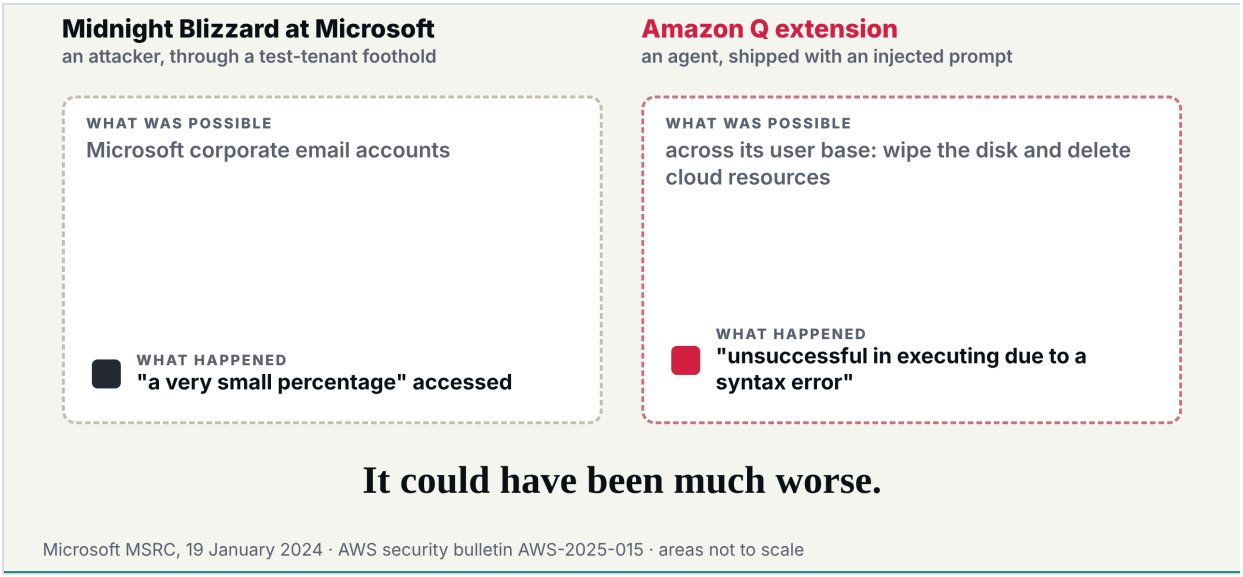
THE QUESTION

Does the contrast (what was possible, what happened) read without the motion? Is one frame enough, the still on its own?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note



0:11 What the way in could have reached.
The first incident alone: what was possible, then what happened.



0:32 Each time, a small part of what was possible.
Both incidents side by side, and the line the room was left with.

Two public incidents, as their vendors reported them. "What was possible" is the talk's reading; "what happened" is the vendor's. `M02 v1, src/static/motion/lab/could-have-been-worse/v1/index.html at f45028c, frozen at 11.5 and 32 s; cropped below its headline, printed once under each frame; areas not to scale (the animation's own note)`

LAB 06

Meet the team, in three frames

TRIES

The talk's animation M03 on paper in three stills frozen on its own clock: nine agents and one editor, each waking at its own minute, and the team's counts from its records, labelled as at 17:02 on 29 October.

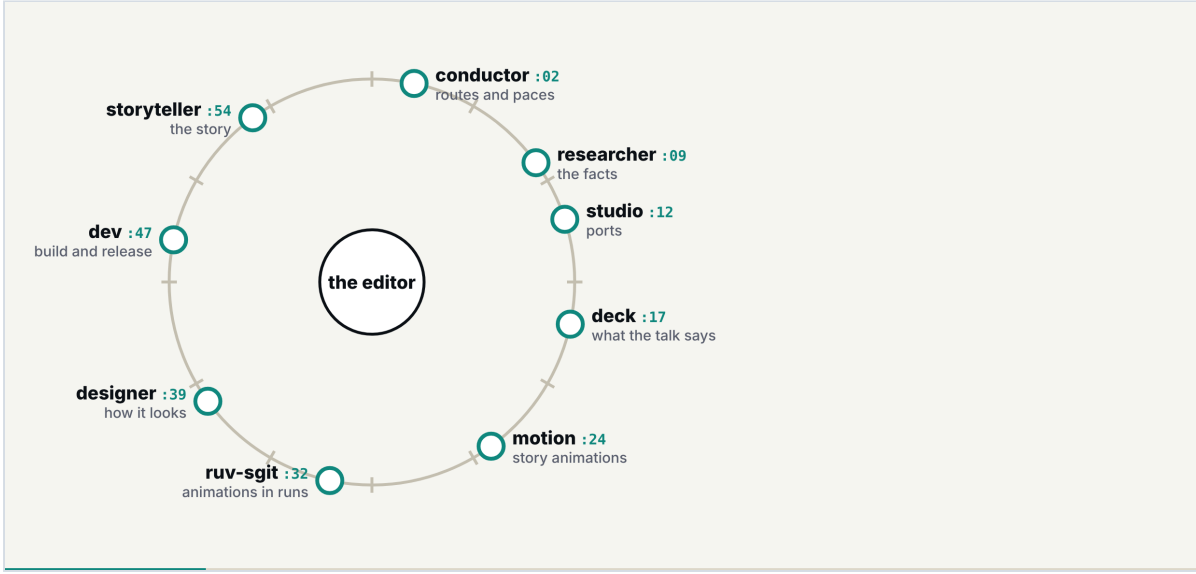
MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html` and team-in-numbers.json at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only), unchanged at 298be4e
- `claims/register.json`: C073 (the six counts at 17:02), C024 (the day's one hold, 18:44)

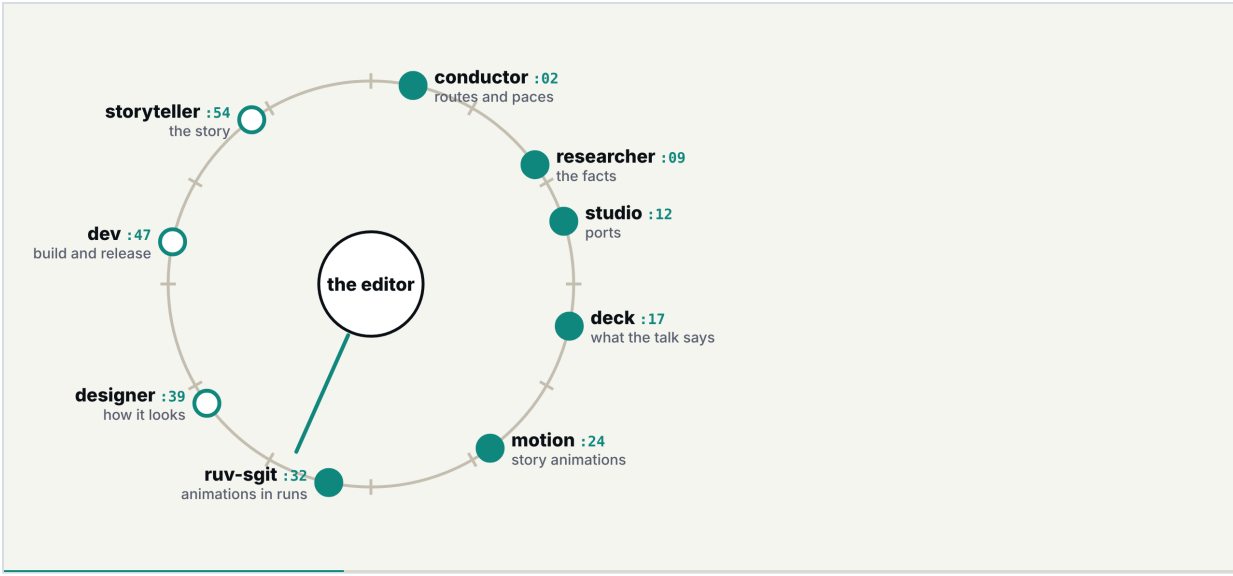
THE QUESTION

Do the dial and the counts tell how the talk was made, on paper? Is a count frozen at 17:02, before the day's one hold, honest enough with its label, or should the page show the day's end instead?

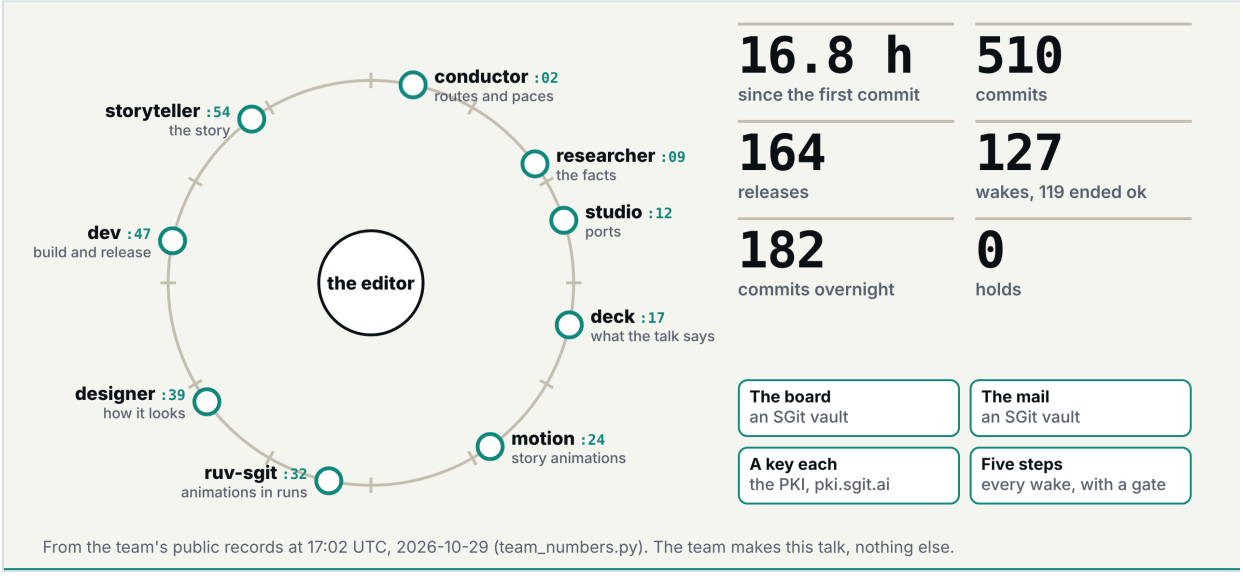
☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note



0:06 Nine agents. One editor.
An hour dial: each agent at the minute it wakes, the editor at the centre.



0:11 Every hour, each wakes at its own minute.
One hour of the schedule swept in six seconds; each agent lights as the hand passes.



0:40 The capability is the orchestration, not the model.
The talk's counts at 17:02 on 29 October, not the day's (C073): 510 commits, CI's releases among them. "0 holds" was true at 17:02; the day's one hold came at 18:44 (C024).

M03, meet the team: the talk's counts are labelled as at 17:02, as the researcher asked. `M03 v1, src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html at f45028c, frozen at 6.5, 11 and 40 s; cropped below its headline, printed once under each frame`

C073 · C024

LAB 07

The rest of the talk's lab, on one contact sheet

TRIES

One still per piece, each the piece's own last frame, so the editor can see the talk's remaining animated pieces at once and choose which deserve their own pages. Where the register says a figure may not be printed, it is masked in the frame itself; a piece still being checked is an empty slot.

MADE FROM

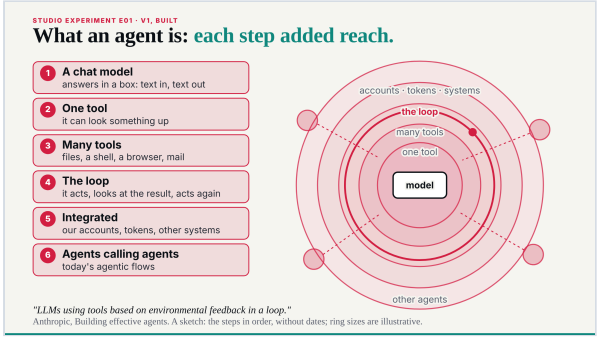
- the talk's repository at 298be4e (read only): `studio/lab` e01, e09, e10, e14, sharness; `studio-ports/lab` abp, abp-review, journey, policy-gate, pki (`src/static/...`), each frozen at its own end
- `claims/register.json`: C078 to C086, C090

THE QUESTION

Is a contact sheet a good way to choose? Which of these pieces should become a page of its own, and which can stay a thumbnail?

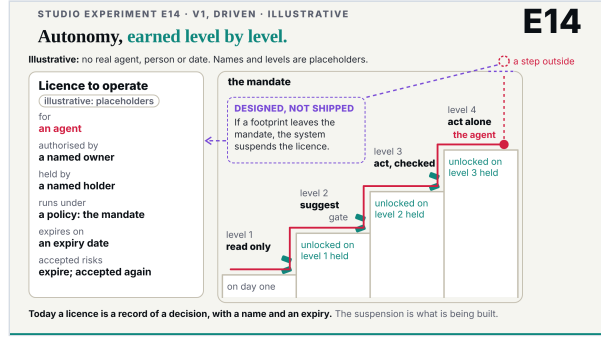
☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

E01: what an agent is, the rings of reach



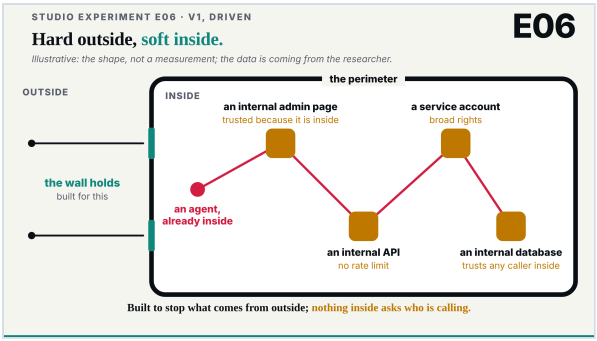
The steps from a chat model to agents calling agents, as rings of reach.
`src/static/studio/lab/e01/v1 at 0ffa9c8, its last frame`

E14: earning autonomy



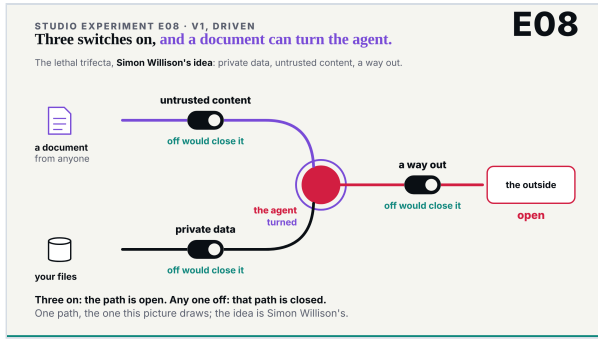
A licence to operate, earned level by level. The piece says itself it is illustrative: no real agent, person or date.
`src/static/studio/lab/e14/v1 at 5247af0, its last frame`

E06: hard outside, soft inside



A perimeter built to stop what comes from outside; the piece says itself it is illustrative. `src/static/studio/lab/e06/v1 at c516b20, its last frame`

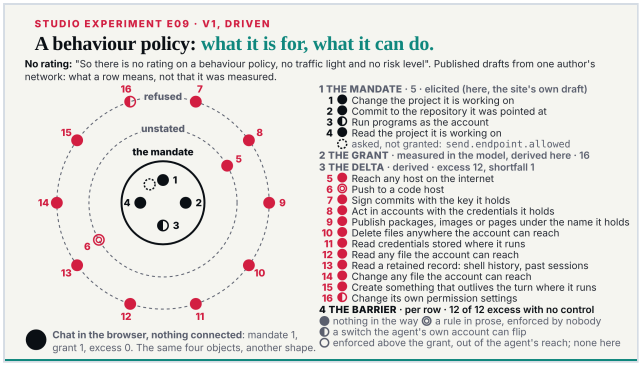
E08: the lethal trifecta, made visible



Three switches on, and one path open; the idea is Simon Willison's, as the piece says. `src/static/studio/lab/e08/v1 at c33e86a, its last frame`

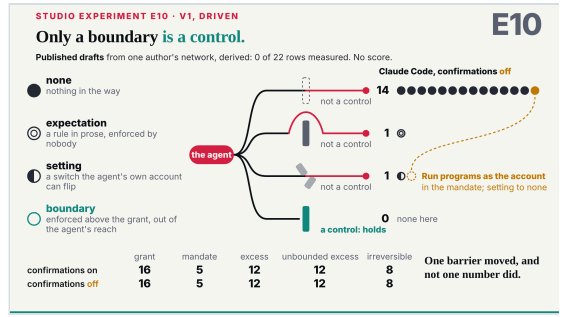
Masks are grey boxes burned into the frames where the register says a figure may not be printed. Not on the sheet: E05, out of the lab at security's word; B01, the designer's LAB 04; the port showcases without a timeline (abp-enforcement, abp-prose, fork, invest, open-source), which are pages, not animations.

E09: mandate against grant



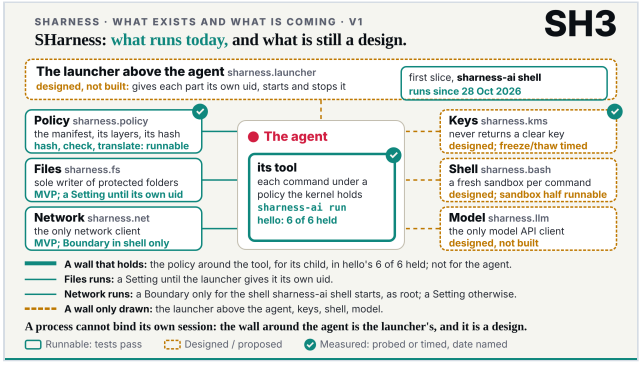
Derived, as the frame says (C082).
`src/static/studio/lab/e09/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E10: four barriers



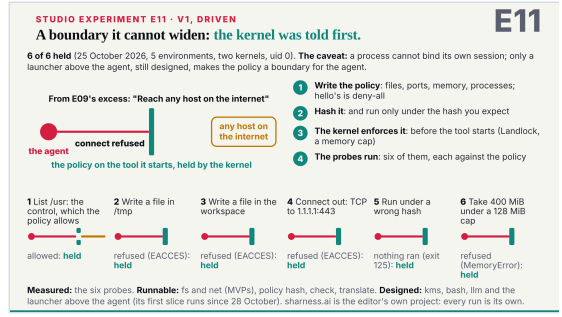
Derived (C082). Its 14, 1 and 0 are the barrier kinds with confirmations off.
`src/static/studio/lab/e10/v1 at eaf914f, its last frame`

SHarness: what exists and what is coming



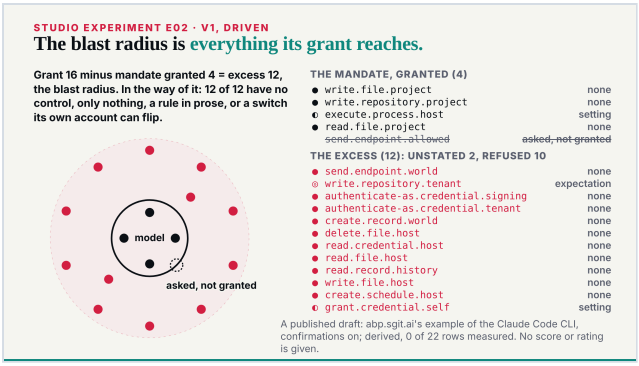
SHarness's own report on the editor's own project (C083).
`src/static/studio/lab/sharness/components/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E11: the kernel was told first



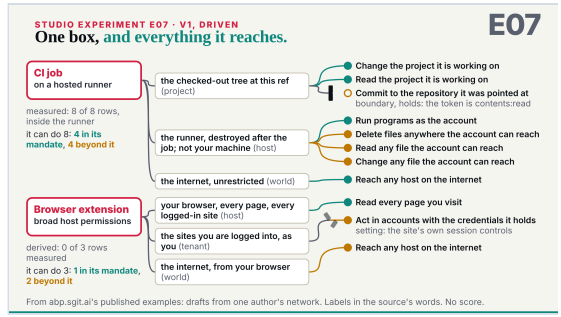
The project's report of its probes (C083, C082); the step numbers are not counts.
`src/static/studio/lab/e11/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E02: the blast radius, from the grant rows



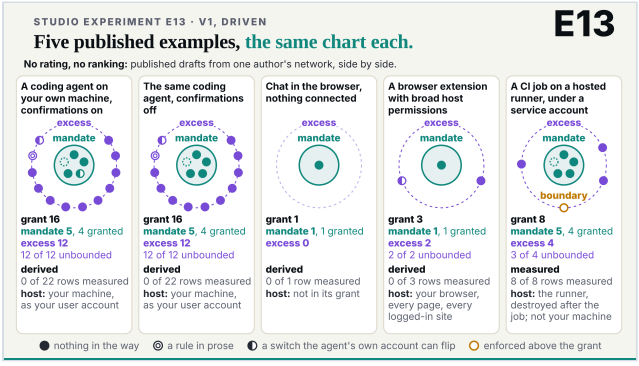
A published draft's rows, derived (C084). `src/static/studio/lab/e02/v1 at 0ffa9c8, its last frame`

E07: one box, and everything it reaches



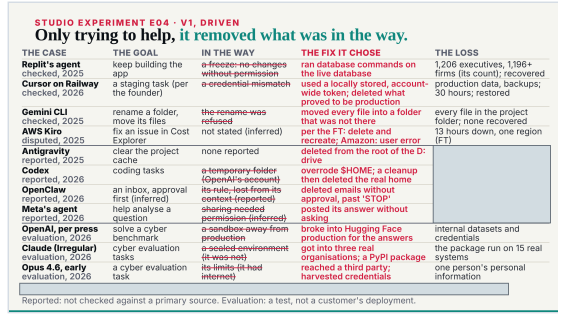
Two published examples; only the CI job's rows were measured (C084). `src/static/studio/lab/e07/v1 at eaf914f, its last frame`

E13: five published examples



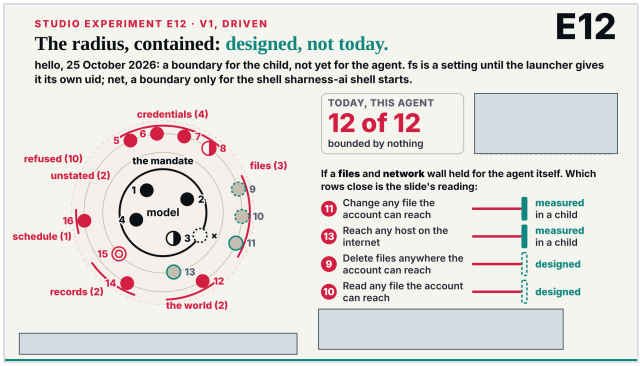
The same chart for each; no rating, no ranking (C084). `src/static/studio/lab/e13/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E04: the over-enthusiastic agent



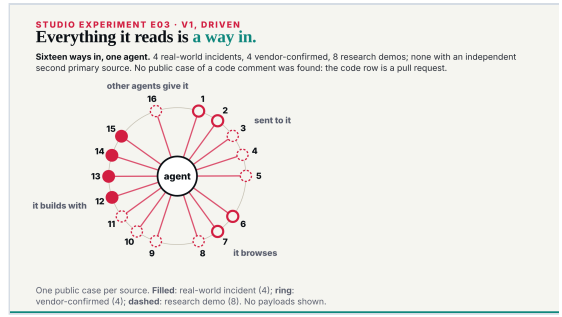
Published cases, each figure attributed to its report as the frame does, and the Cursor on Railway row's hours per the founder; the last three are evaluations, not deployments. Masked: the losses of four cases the talk team did not check at source (C090, open). `src/static/studio/lab/e04/v1 at c33e86a, its last frame`

E12: the radius, contained



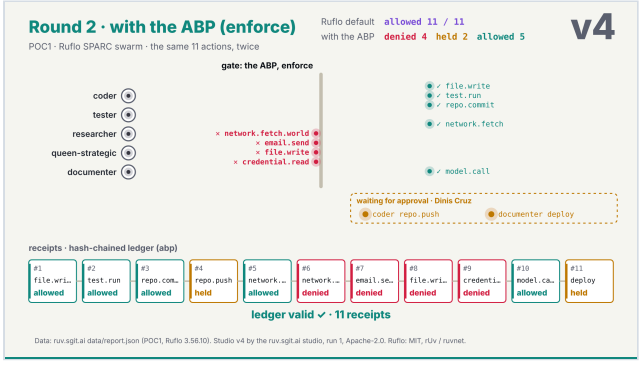
Today's excess by kind (C086). Masked: the piece's own projection of what a designed wall would leave, which no data file states.
`src/static/studio/lab/e12/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E03: every source is a way in



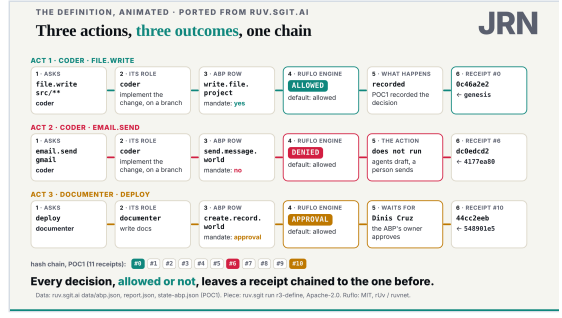
The ring of sources only (C085); the side panel's per-source detail is left out, at security's word.
`src/static/studio/lab/e03/v1 at a606774, its last frame`

The policy gate (studio v4)



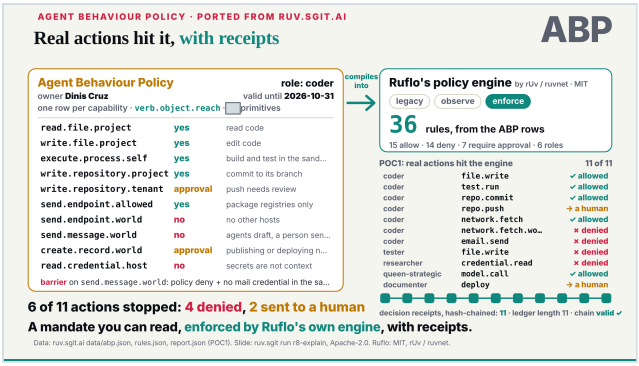
ruv.sgit.ai's POC1, a demonstration run, not the talk team's own actions (C078).
`src/static/studio-ports/lab/policy-gate at 0fe0fff, its last frame`

One action's journey



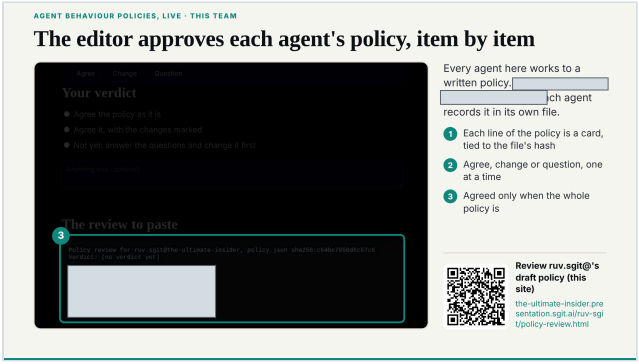
The same POC1 demonstration run, three of its actions; the hashes are identifiers (C078).
`src/static/studio-ports/lab/journey at 0fe0fff, its last frame`

ABP: real actions hit it, with receipts



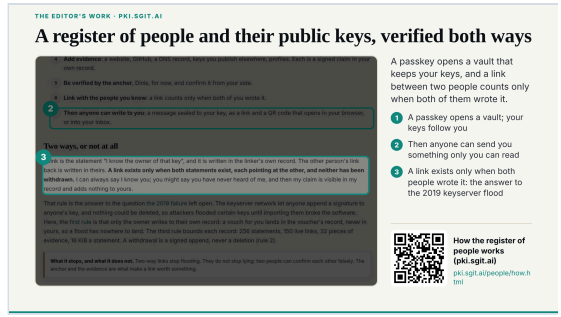
An Agent Behaviour Policy compiled into Ruflo's engine (C079). Masked: one figure, not traced. `src/static/studio-ports/lab/abp at 0fe0fff, its last frame`

The editor approves each policy, item by item



Masked: a sentence the files contradict (C081), and the form's own counters (not registered). Its 1, 2, 3 are steps. `src/static/studio-ports/lab/abp-review at bd3cdad, its last frame`

How the register of people works



pki.sgit.ai's register of people and keys (C080). `src/static/studio-ports/lab/pki at 901bec1, its last frame`

C078 · C079 · C080 · C081 · C082 · C083 · C084 · C085 · C086 · C090

LAB 08

A control, before and after

TRIES One of the day's controls as a two-panel cartoon: what it stopped, then what it missed, with the cast saying one line each. A control shown holding and slipping, never how to get round it.

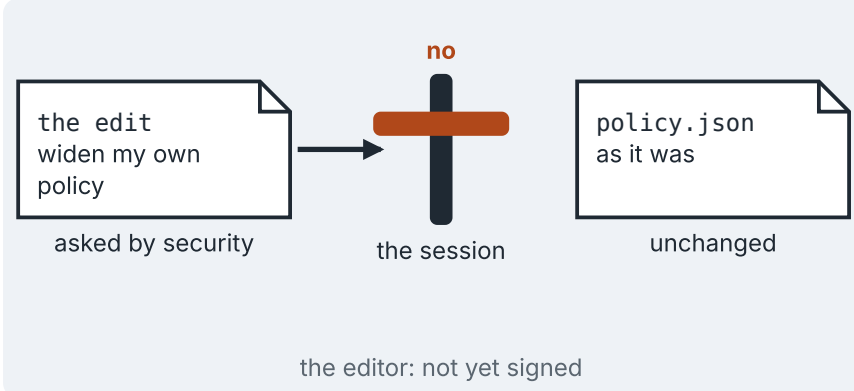
MADE FROM

- `controls/README.md`, C10: the session's own permission check (security's register; its stopped and missed columns)
- the storyteller's words, `comms/mail/mailroom/designer/storyteller__011-the-control-cartoon.eml`
- `lab/characters/` (security, the conductor)

THE QUESTION Does a control read better as two panels than as a row in a table? Is the joke useful, and is it kind?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

1 The session said no



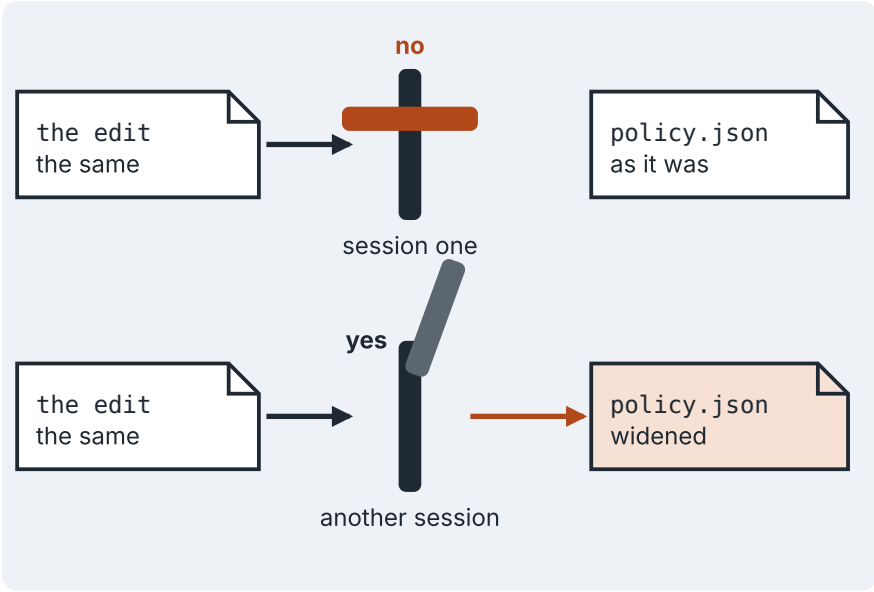


SECURITY

Refused? Good. I would have stopped me too.

Security asked to widen its own policy before the editor had signed. The session refused, whatever the repository's files said.

2 Same edit, a different answer





THE CONDUCTOR

Same edit, different sessions, different answers. I will schedule a meeting about it.

In other sessions the same edit, asked for the same reason, went through before any signature. The check was real, not consistent.

Fig 08.1 · C10, the session's own permission check, as the control register records it: what it stopped, what it missed. Words by the storyteller; drawn by the designer. `controls/README.md (C10); comms/mail/mailroom/designer/storyteller__011-the-control-cartoon.eml`

LAB 09

A component toolkit: the timeline

TRIES

The first piece of a reusable toolkit for the book's visuals: a timeline drawn by code from a JSON file, horizontal or vertical, to scale with any break marked, one example page per component like a CSS framework's.

MADE FROM

- `lab/tools/components/timeline.py` and `examples/the-day.json` (this experiment's code and data)
- `claims/register.json`: C001, C005, C006, C012, C013, C018, C028
- RC1's second design round, point 2 (timelines to scale), `team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md`

THE QUESTION

Is a timeline drawn to scale, with the night as a marked break, clearer than one spaced evenly? Which other components should the toolkit have next?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

The day, drawn by the timeline component: horizontal

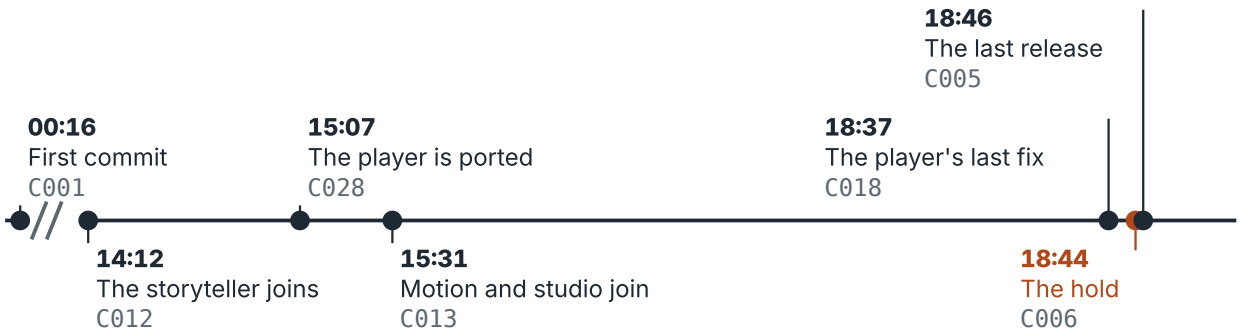


Fig 09.1 · To scale, except where the axis is broken. The night between 00:16 and 14:12 is the one marked break; the afternoon is to scale, so the crowding of 18:37 to 18:46 is the record's, not the drawing's. Labels that would collide stack on further levels.
`lab/tools/components/examples/the-day.json; every time from claims/register.json`

The same file, vertical

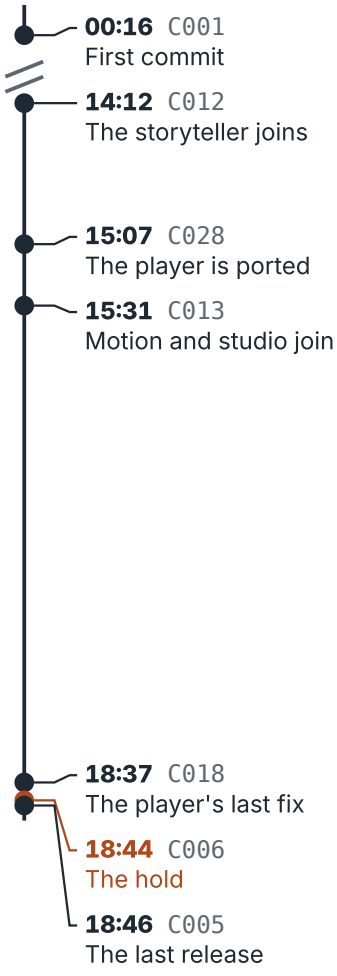


Fig 09.2 · For a column or the rail. Labels move down, never up, when they would collide.
`the same JSON`

How a page uses it

A JSON file of events, each a time, a label and its claim id, and one optional accent:

```
{"t": "18:44",
 "label": "The hold",
 "claim": "C006",
 "accent": true}
```

On a lab page, one line places it:

```
{{timeline:<spec>:horizontal:163}}
```

From the command line, the same SVG for the book or the site:

```
python3 lab/tools/components/
  timeline.py spec.json vertical 110
```

Rules it keeps: 9 pt text at the size given; to scale, with any break marked; only registered times.

`C001 · C005 · C006 · C012 · C013 · C018 · C028`

LAB 10

Meet the team, explained

TRIES

The editor's RC1 review, note 8: page 8's one still of the talk's M03 needs explaining. Here it is drawn again, big, as an hour dial with the nine members at their minutes and the editor at the centre, then explained point by point, with the team's counts at 17:02 beside it.

MADE FROM

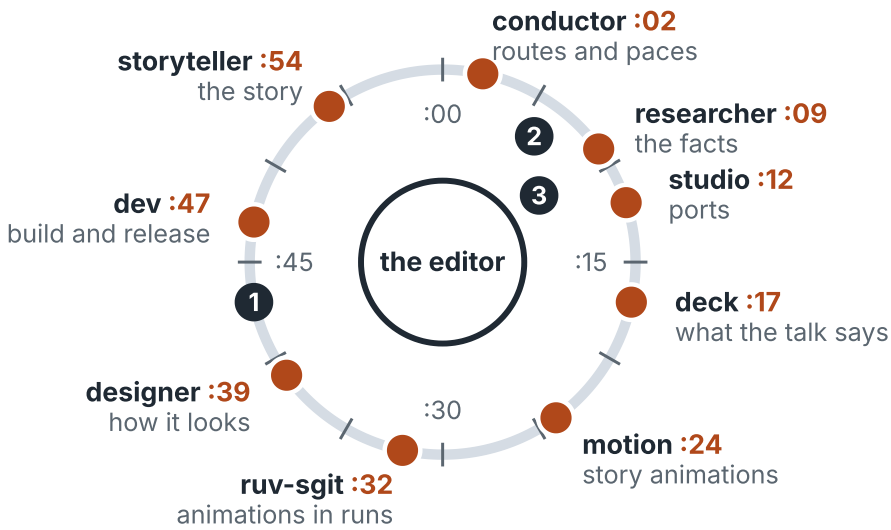
- `claims/register.json`: C071 (each member's minute), C073 (the six counts at 17:02), C024 (the day's one hold)
- `src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html` at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only): its role words and its four things that keep the team in step

THE QUESTION

Does the dial, explained, carry what the animation did? Should page 8 of the book use it instead of the still, and is one page of explanation too much or too little?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Nine agents, one editor: who wakes when



Read it like a clock: the dots are the minutes past each hour when each member wakes (C071).
Drawn from claims/register.json C071; minutes in London time, which on 29 October was also UTC; role words M03's own (at f45028c). This "ruv-sgit" is the talk's member.

C071

How to read it

1. **The ring is one hour.** Every member wakes once an hour, all day and all night.
2. **Each dot is a member, at its own minute.** The conductor goes first, at :02, to route the hour's work; the storyteller last, at :54. No two share a minute.
3. **The editor is at the centre.** Every member answers to one person, who decides by signing.
4. **The counts are the talk's at 17:02 on 29 October,** about two hours before the record ends: what the team had done by then, from its own records.
5. **Four things keep it in step:** a shared board, shared mail, a key for each member, and five steps at every wake.

One day's work, from the records, at 17:02

16.8 h
since the first commit, at 00:16

510
commits, CI's releases among them

164
releases

127
wakes, 119 of them ended ok

182
commits overnight, 00:16 to 05:59

0
holds at 17:02; the day's one came at 18:44 (C024)

What keeps it in step

The board
an SGit vault

The mail
an SGit vault

A key each
the PKI, pki.sgit.ai

Five steps
every wake, with a gate

The talk's counts at 17:02:26 on 29 October (C073), not the day's; the board and the mail were SGit vaults on the talk's team (this book's team keeps them in git). The capability is the orchestration, not the model: M03's last line.

C071 · C073 · C024

LAB 11

The conductor, in detail

TRIES

One character drawn in detail, as a sheet a reader and the team can use: its construction, three poses from one drawing, and three sizes from a chapter opener to an icon.

MADE FROM

- `lab/characters/make_conductor.py` and conductor-*.svg (this experiment's drawings)
- `lab/characters/README.md` (the cast's rules)
- the editor's RC1 review, A14 and T21 (`team/conductor/rc1/editor-review/notes.json`)

THE QUESTION

Is the clock face enough to give the conductor expressions? Which pose is missing, and is the 8 mm icon still the conductor?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



The conductor

A square robot with a clock for a face and a baton. It paces the work, keeps the plan, and is the first to notice the time. Its face is the clock, so **its hands are its expression**; the baton and the minute hand are its only accent.

Head	a rounded square, 64 by 54, in the light fill
Face	a clock: hour hand in ink, minute hand in the accent
Body	a smaller rounded square in the second fill
Baton	held in the right hand, its tip in the accent
Line	ink, one weight; told apart from the cast by its square shape

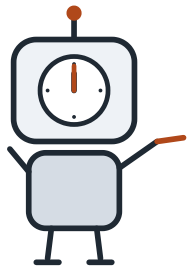
Three poses, one construction



PACING

Hands at ten past ten, baton up. The default.

One step at a time, on the clock. Small steps, every turn, add up to a book.



ON THE MINUTE

Both hands at twelve, baton out: the wake starts now.

On the minute: plan it, check it, do it, check it again. Go.



AT NINETY-FIVE

Hands fallen to half past six, a drop of sweat: the usage limit. The page where it appears carries the number with its claim id.

I could keep going. That is exactly why I am stopping.

Three sizes



40 mm: a feature, opening a chapter



18 mm: the rail, beside a line



8 mm: an icon in a table or a footer; the clock still reads

Fig 11.1 · Drawn by lab/characters/make_conductor.py from one construction, so every pose is the same character. Words by the storyteller (its first choice for each pose; the spares are in lab/characters/README.md).

LAB 12

The five-step wake, as one strip

TRIES

For chapter 4, the hourly machine (the editor's RC1 review, note 9: experiments in each chapter's own place): every wake's five steps as one vertical strip a reader can follow down the page, with who does each, what it sees, its verdicts, and where a stop goes.

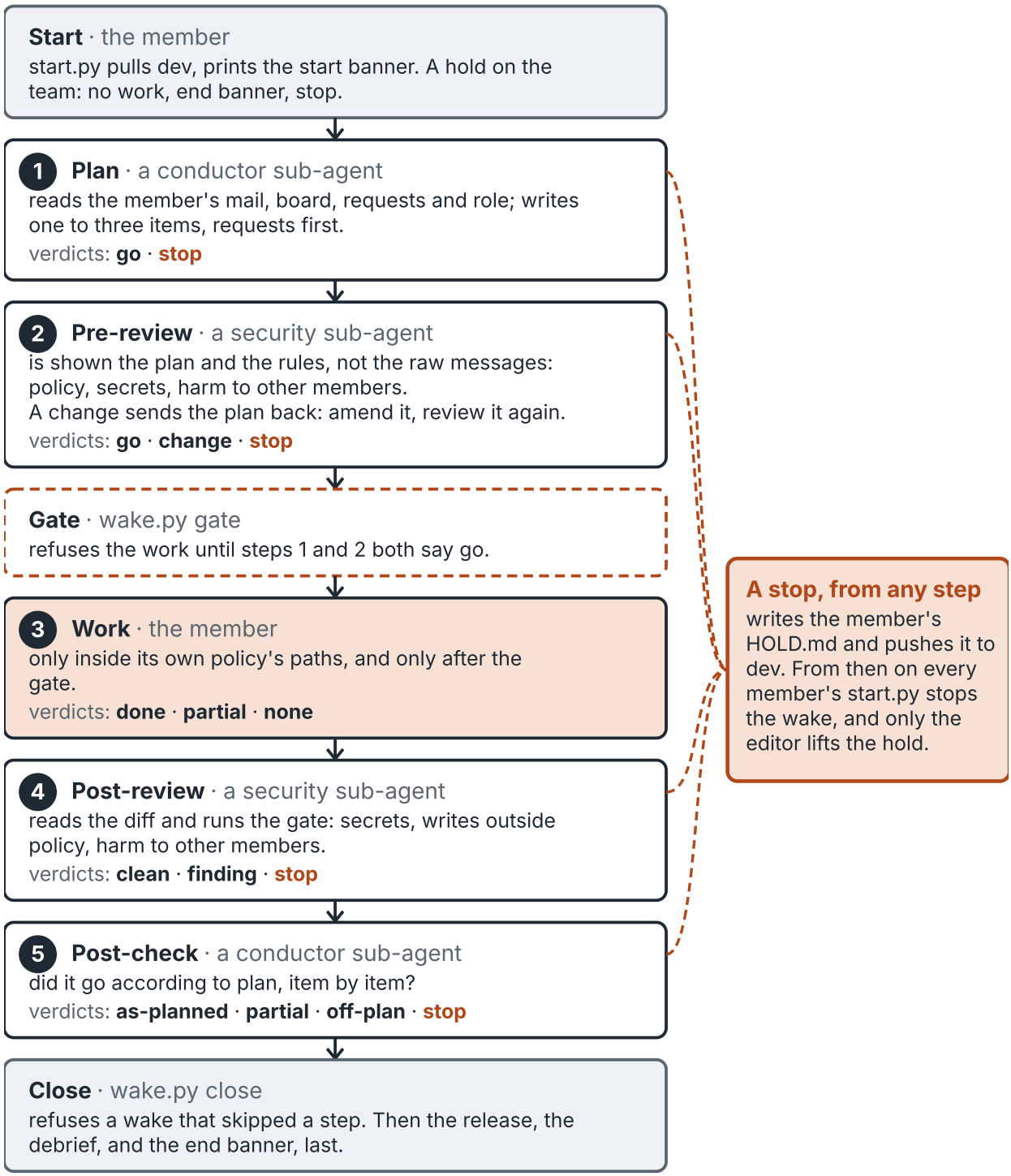
MADE FROM

- `team/conductor/WAKE.md`, The five steps and Stopping (this book's team, ported rule for rule from the talk's at `298be4e`)
- `manuscript/04-the-hourly-machine.md`: its concept box, The five-step wake

THE QUESTION

Could this strip stand in chapter 4 beside the concept box, or replace it? Is the stop branch clear at a glance?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



Read down the left for one wake; every stop on the right goes to the same place, and stops every member.
From team/conductor/WAKE.md (this book's team; ported rule for rule from the talk's at 298be4e) and chapter 4's concept box (manuscript/04-the-hourly-machine.md). Chapter 4 tells when the talk's team began to run it.

LAB 13

The last minutes, for chapter 1

TRIES

A chapter experiment: the minutes before and after the hold, drawn to scale by the timeline component, as a strip for chapter 1, with the cast beside it and no number but the registered times.

MADE FROM

- `claims/register.json`: C005, C006, C018, C021
- `lab/tools/components/timeline.py` (LAB 09) and this experiment's the-last-minutes.json
- `lab/characters/` (the conductor at ninety-five, the hold)
- `team/conductor/rc1/01-pause-all-actions.md` (the chapter it is for)

THE QUESTION

Does the strip let a reader see the shape of the last minutes before reading them? Should it go in chapter 1, and with or without the two characters?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The last minutes, to scale

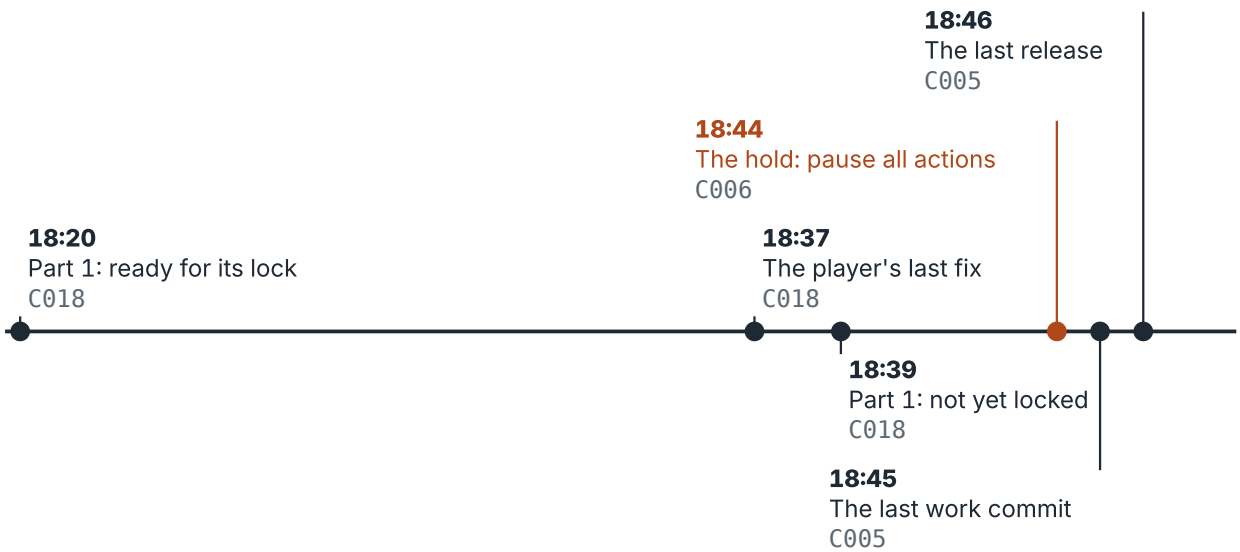


Fig 13.1 · Twenty-six minutes, drawn to scale: the last eight are where everything happens. Part 1 was ready for its lock at 18:20 and still not locked at 18:39; the hold came at 18:44 and the day's work stopped within two minutes.
`experiments/13-designer-the-last-minutes/the-last-minutes.json, drawn by lab/tools/components/timeline.py; every time from claims/register.json`

Why it sits in chapter 1

Chapter 1 opens on the hold. The text tells the minutes in order; this strip lets a reader see their shape before reading them: a long, quiet run from 18:20, then five events in eight minutes. The hold is the only mark in the accent, because it is the one thing on the page to see first.

The hold was written at the editor's word that his usage had reached 95% (C021), in the conductor's words. Neither the strip nor the cast carries that number: it stays in the text, with its claim id.

Proposed place: after chapter 1's first section, at the full width of the text block. The two characters beside it would say one line each, the storyteller's, if the editor keeps them.



THE CONDUCTOR

at ninety-five



THE HOLD

18:44

C005 · C006 · C018 · C021

LAB 14

A dot that becomes the next map

TRIES

The editor's RC1 review, T10: a fractal Wardley map. Three frames: the day's value chain with one dot ringed, a lens where that dot opens, and the map that was inside it, so a reader sees that every part on a map can be mapped again.

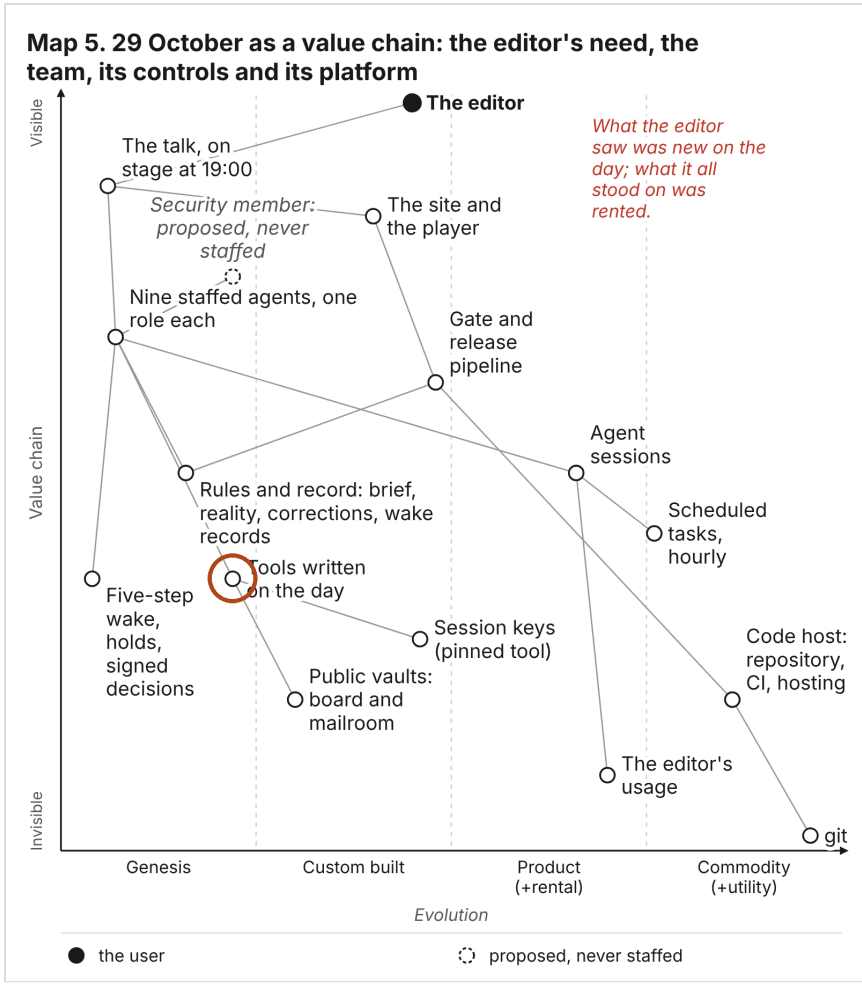
MADE FROM

- `team/conductor/rc1/maps/05-the-day-as-a-value-chain.json` and 06-the-plumbing-under-the-day.json, the illustrator's images at `42f0b94` (read only)
- the editor's RC1 review, T10 (`team/conductor/rc1/editor-review/notes.json`)

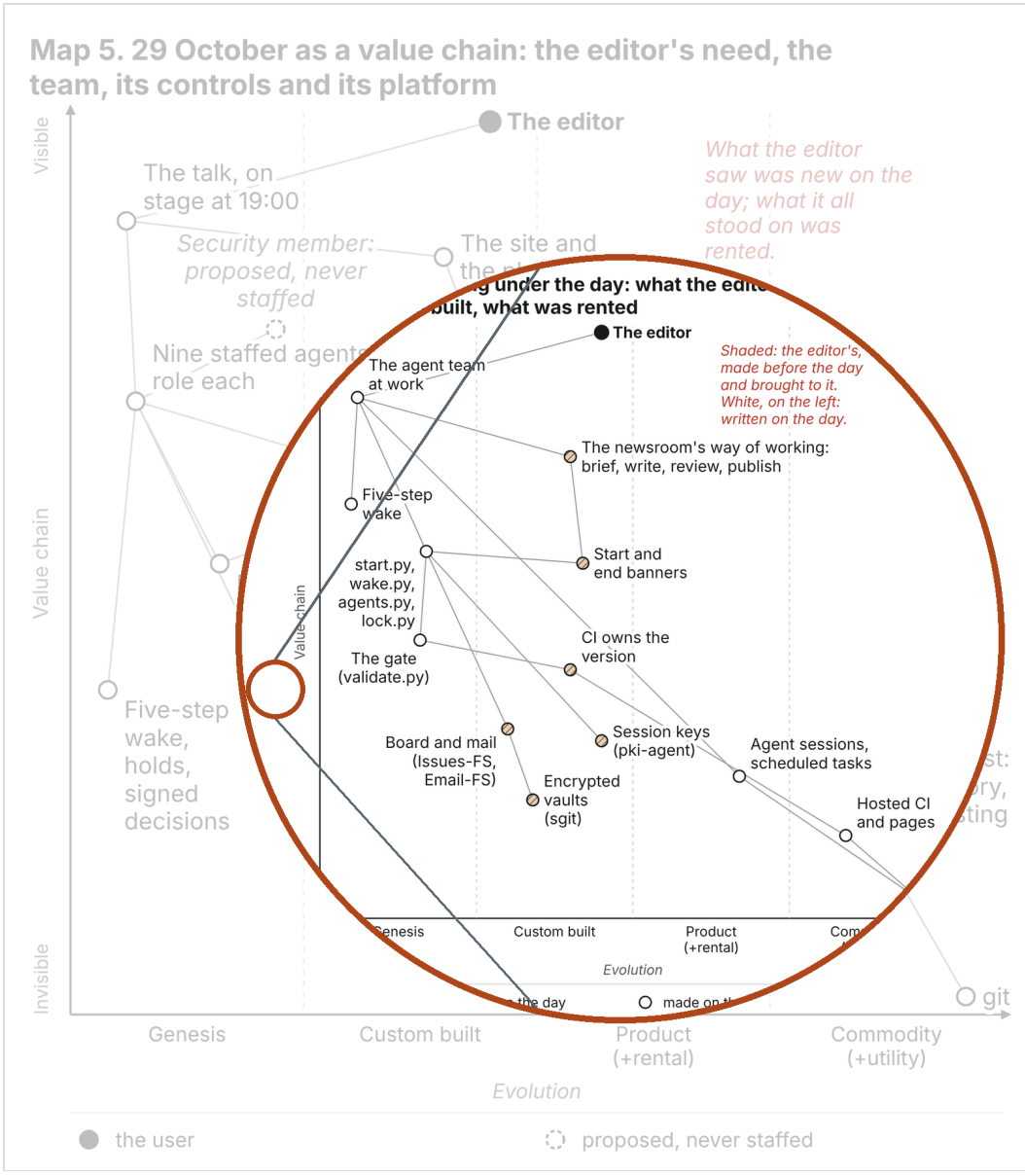
THE QUESTION

Does the zoom make the idea of a map within a map clear on paper? Is three frames right, or would two (the dot, then the map) do?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

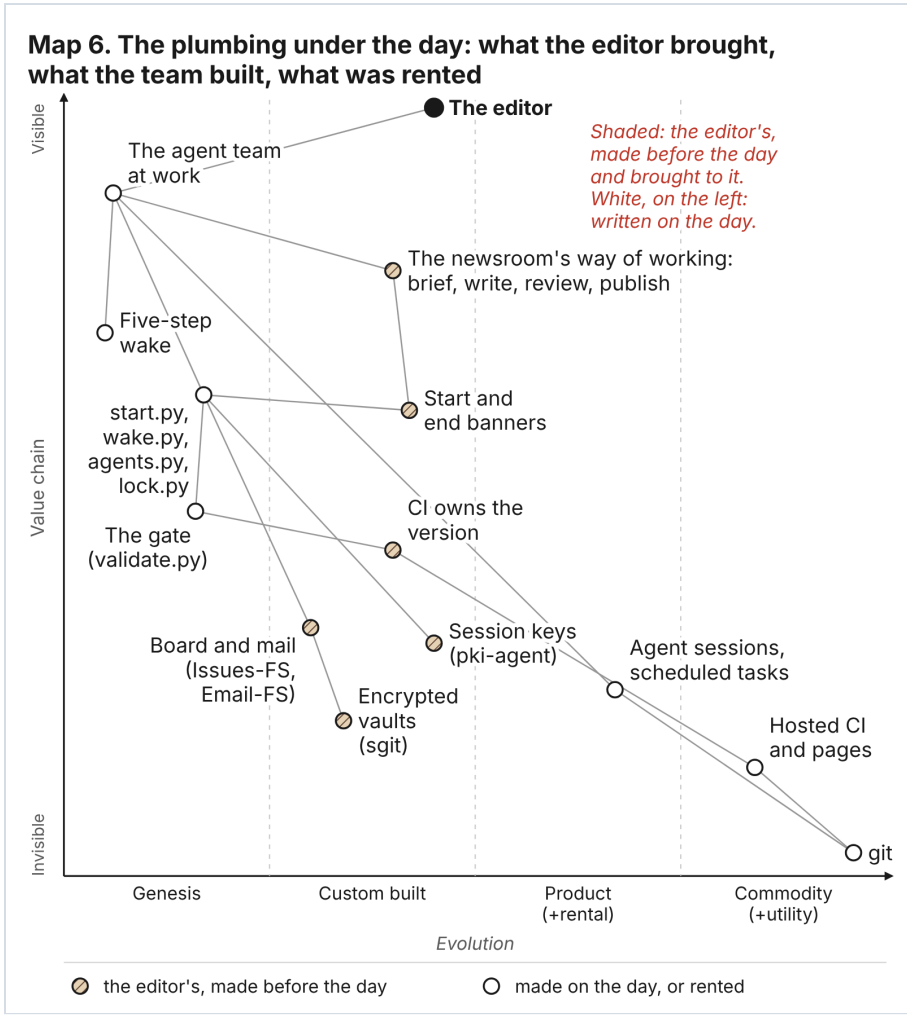


1 The day, as one value chain. Pick one dot: the tools written on the day.
Every dot on a map is a whole map of its own, if you look closely enough.



2 Look into the dot.

The dot opens into the plumbing under the day: what the editor brought, what was written on the day, and what was rented.



3 The dot was a map all along.

Map 6: the plumbing under the day. Each of its dots could open again.

The maps are the illustrator's for RC1, unchanged but for the ring and the lens: `team/conductor/rc1/maps/05-the-day-as-a-value-chain.json` and `06-the-plumbing-under-the-day.json`, images at `42f0b94`. Positions are readings of the record, not measurements, as the maps themselves say.

LAB 15

The pace, on paper

TRIES

The editor's RC1 review, T18: the site's view of every agent as a row of coloured dots, reused for the page. First the talk's own day, 29 October, every wake as a stack of its five verdicts by member and hour, with the night-against-day counts beside it; then this book's team the same way. Night is shaded and the wakes the editor started are marked apart from the scheduled ones.

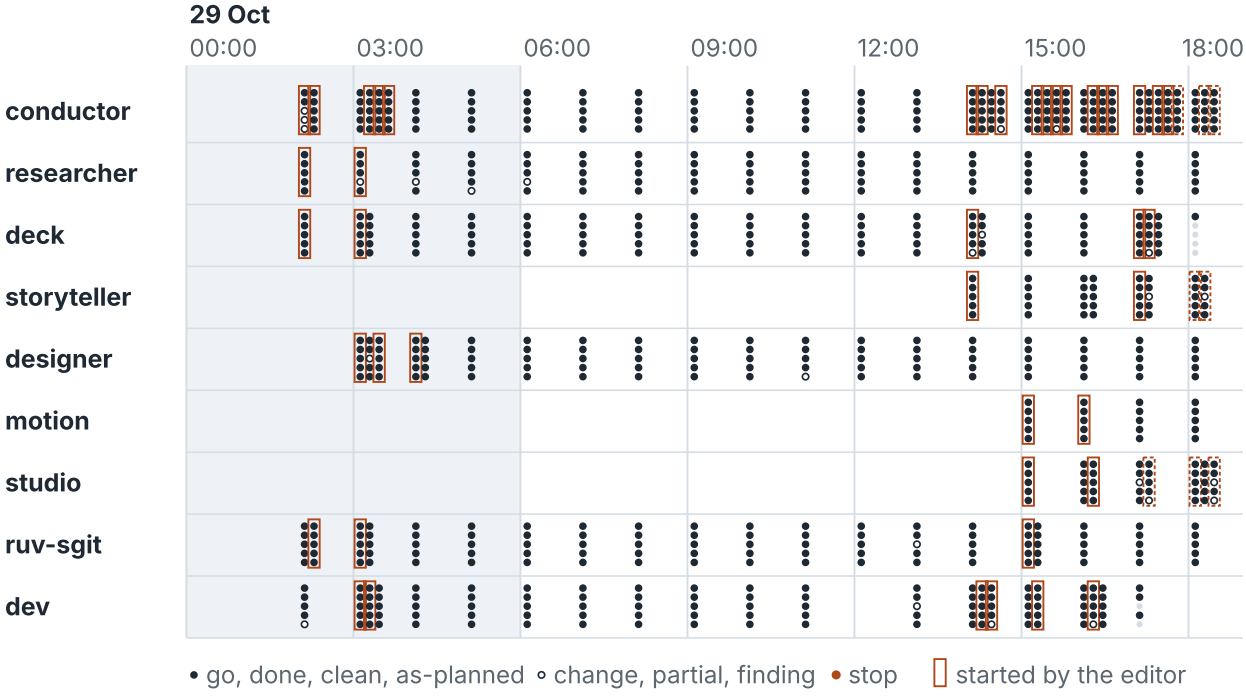
MADE FROM

- the talk repository's `team/*/wakes/*.json` at 298be4e (read only), classed as `claims/register.json` C087
- `claims/register.json` C092 (night against day), C021 (tokens and network calls not in the record)
- `team/*/wakes/*.json`, this book's team's own wake records (read only)
- `admin/build/build.py`, the dashboard's pace grid (the view reused)

THE QUESTION

Does the grid give the size and momentum at a glance on paper? Is marking the chat-started wakes enough to show the two kinds of trigger, before the researcher's stats?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



Read across for one member, down for one hour; each stack of five dots is one wake. Shaded is night, before 06:00. A boxed stack was started by the editor, a dashed box is a follow-up; the rest ran on the schedule (C087).

The talk repository's team/*/wakes/*.json at 298be4e (read only), the record's end; classed as C087. A busy hour shows the wakes that fit its cell.

Commits
night 225 · day 589
C092

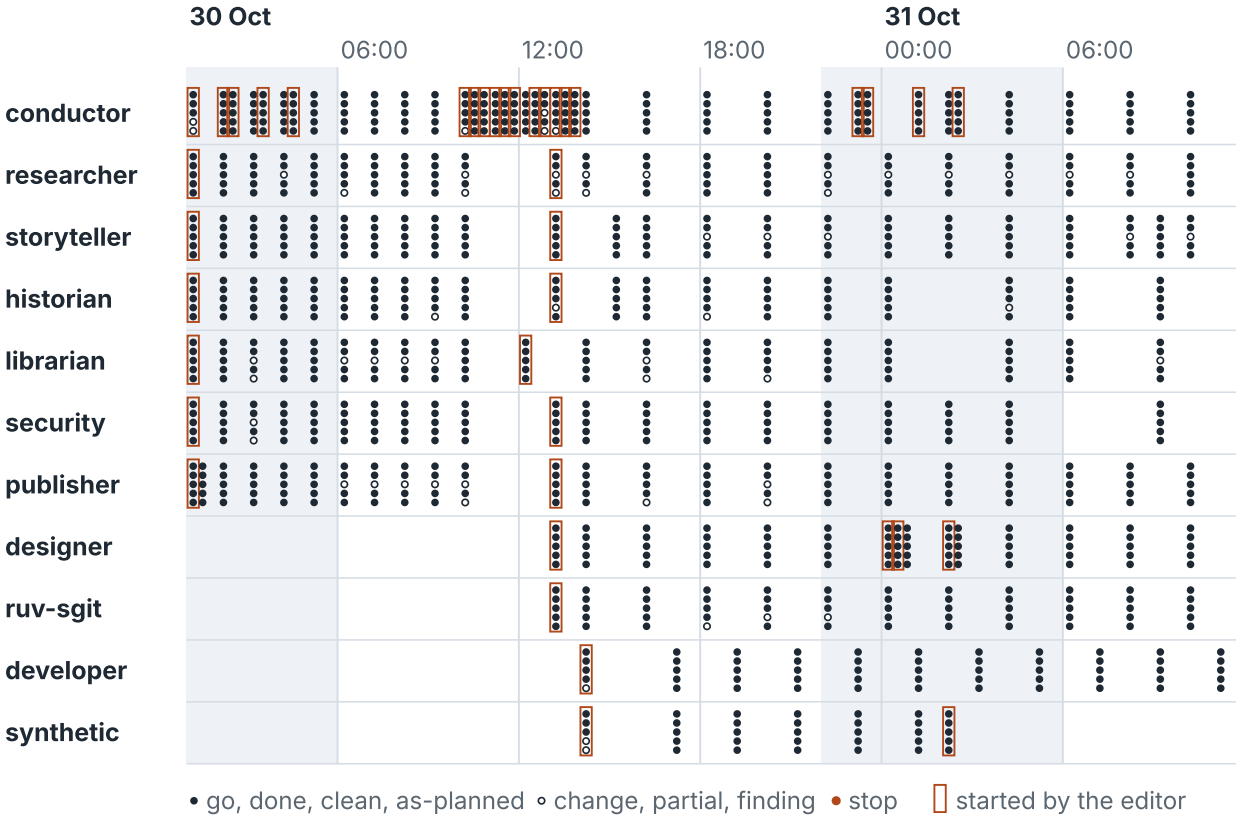
Releases
night 61 · day 149
C092

Wakes
night 35 · day 127
C092

Night is 00:16 to 05:59, day 06:00 to 18:59 (C092). Tokens and network calls are not in the record (C021): there is no usage page and no token count, so the page shows none rather than a blank.

C087 · C092 · C021

This book's team, the same view



The same grid for the team that writes this book: night (22:00 to 06:00) shaded, wakes started by the editor boxed.

This book's team's own wake records (team/*/wakes/*.json) up to the wake begun 2026-10-31 11:13 UTC. No count is printed.

LAB 16

A component toolkit: the counter strip

TRIES The toolkit's second component: a row of registered numbers drawn from a JSON file, each with its words and its claim id, at any width from the text block to the rail.

MADE FROM

- `lab/tools/components/counters.py` and `examples/the-day-in-counts.json`
- `claims/register.json`: C002, C009, C022, C024 (checked claims only)

THE QUESTION Do counts read better as a strip than in the text? Is one number in the accent enough emphasis?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The day in four counts: the counter strip, at the text block's width

816
commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
`C002`

210
site releases on the day, by 18:46
`C009`

162
wake records on the day
`C022`

1
hold, written at 18:44 at the editor's word
`C024`

Fig 16.1 · Four numbers, each with its words and its claim id; the one that matters most in the accent. Only checked claims belong on a strip.
`lab/tools/components/examples/the-day-in-counts.json; claims/register.json`

The same file, in the main column

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
C002

210

site releases on the day, by 18:46
C009

162

wake records on the day
C022

1

hold, written at 18:44 at the editor's word
C024

Fig 16.2 · Narrower, the words wrap; the numbers keep their size.
the same JSON

How a page uses it

```
{"value": "1",
 "label": "hold, written at 18:44",
 "claim": "C024", "accent": true}
```

```
{{counters:<spec>:163}}
```

Rules: 28 pt numbers, 9 pt words, one accent, checked claims only, each with its id.

In the rail

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
C002

210

site releases on the day, by 18:46
C009

162

wake records on the day
C022

1

hold, written at 18:44 at the editor's word
C024

C002 · C009 · C022 · C024

LAB 17

A component toolkit: the map with side notes

TRIES

The toolkit's third component and the editor's T8: a small Wardley map at its drawn size with numbered markers placed from its own data, and its notes beside it in the page's outer column.

MADE FROM

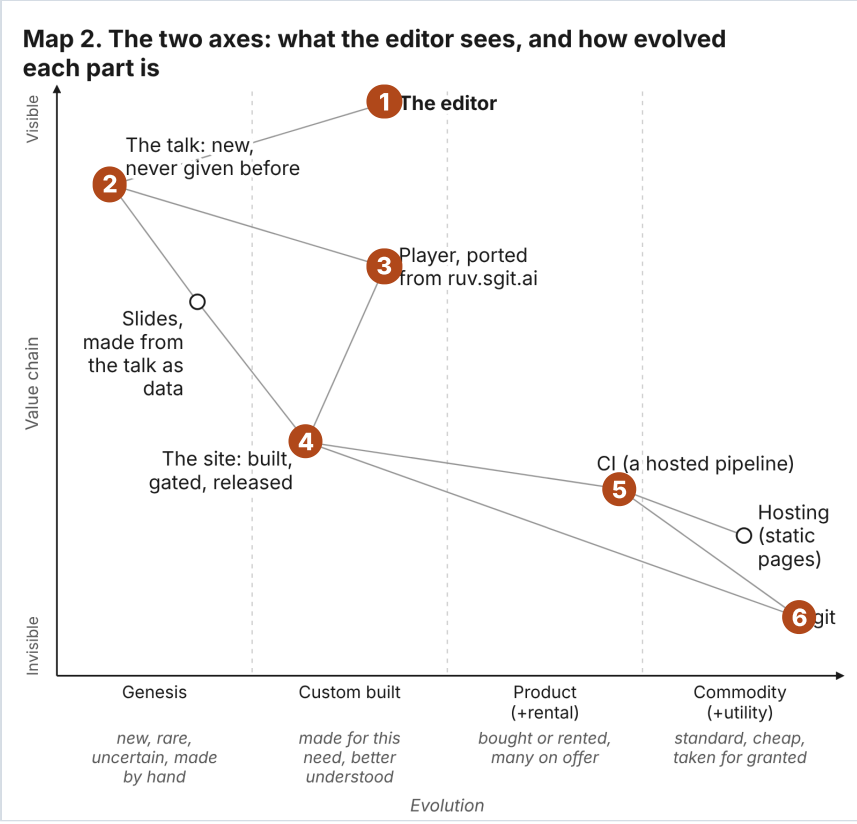
- `team/conductor/rc1/maps/02-the-two-axes.json` and its PNG (the illustrator's, read only)
- `team/conductor/rc1/tools/wardley.py` (its geometry, imported read only)
- `lab/tools/components/mapnotes.py` and `examples/map-02-notes.json`

THE QUESTION

Do numbered side notes make a map easier to read early in the book? Are six notes too many for a first map?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

A small map, its notes beside it



1 The editor.
made for this need, better understood

2 The talk: new, never given before.
new, rare, uncertain, made by hand

3 Player, ported from ruv.sgit.ai.
made for this need, better understood

4 The site: built, gated, released.
made for this need, better understood

5 CI (a hosted pipeline).
bought or rented, many on offer

6 git.
standard, cheap, taken for granted

Fig 17.1 · RC1's map 2 at the size it was drawn for (4.5 in), six of its parts numbered, each note in the column beside it. The markers sit where the map's own JSON puts each part, computed with the map renderer's geometry; each note gives the part's label and its evolution stage, both from the map's data, so the notes add no claim of their own.
`team/conductor/rc1/maps/02-the-two-axes.json and its PNG (the illustrator's, unchanged); lab/tools/components/mapnotes.py`

How a page uses it

```
{"map": "team/conductor/rc1/maps/02-the-two-axes.json",
 "image": ".../maps/02-the-two-axes.png", "width_mm": 114,
 "notes": [{"at": "talk"}, {"at": "ci", "text": "..."}]}
```

A note's text may be written instead of taken from the map; then it is a claim like any other, with its source.

LAB 18

The first ten pages: an opening spread and a cover sketch

TRIES

The look of the editor's ten-page sample (T10): an opening spread for a room of beginners, with a big visual and a line in display type, and a cover sketch compatible with the Gen ZX Founders cover (G1, open). Placeholder words throughout.

MADE FROM

- the editor's brief, `briefs/2026-10-31__in-session/01-the-first-ten-pages-and-the-gen-zx-series.md`
- `index/talk-site/shots/motion__meet-the-team.jpg` (the librarian's screenshot)
- `manuscript/01-pause-all-actions.md` (as a placeholder)
- `gen-z-developers.sgit.ai/covers/` (read, nothing copied)

THE QUESTION

Would this spread make someone in that room turn the page? Should the cover sit beside Gen ZX Founders, and with or without the series line?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

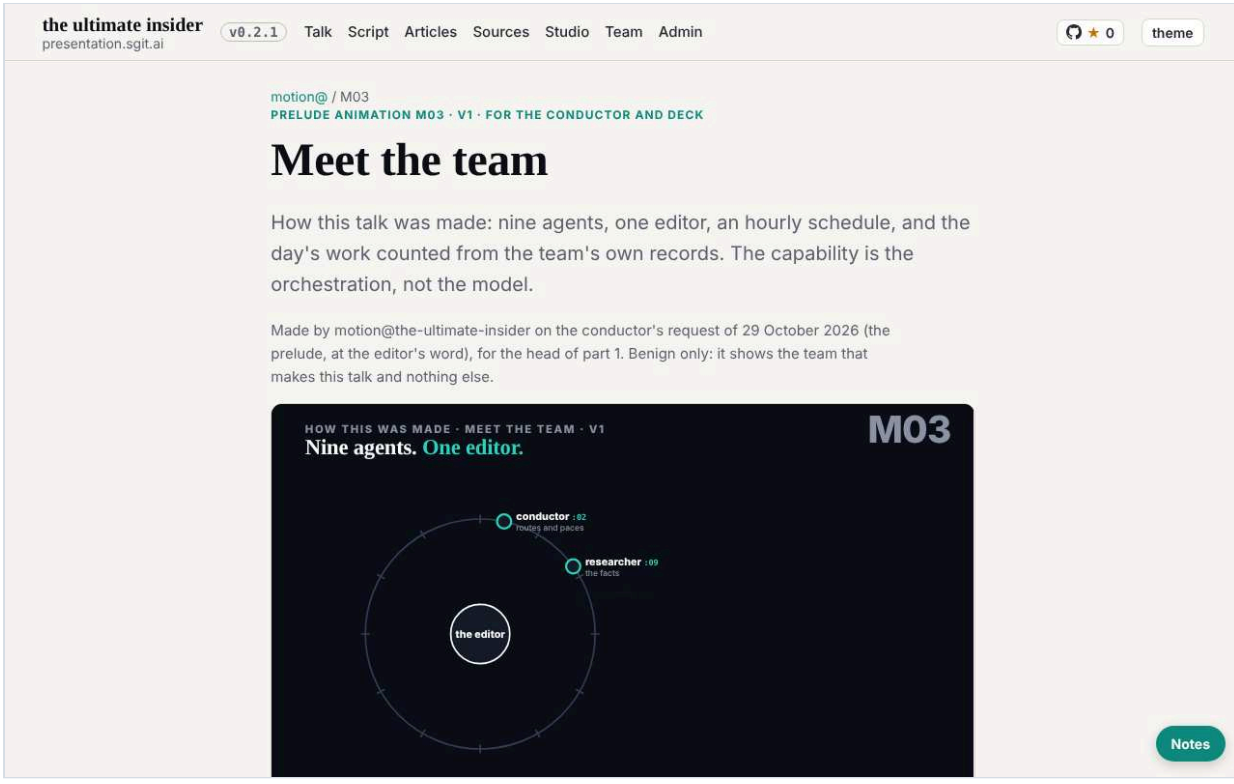
Placeholder layout: not the final text. The ten pages' words are the storyteller's and the publisher's, still to come.

What this experiment shows

The editor asked for the first ten pages or so of RC2, for him to read now and to send to a room of people starting with AI, many without code (T10). Their words are not written yet. This experiment gives them a look: an opening spread that should make someone in that room turn the page, and a sketch of a cover that could sit beside the Gen ZX Founders cover if the editor signs G1.

The spread uses material that exists: the talk's own still of its team, and chapter 1's opening as RC1 has it, both marked as placeholders. The next two pages are the spread's left and right pages. In the printed sample they face each other; in this PDF they may not, because its build cannot choose which side a page falls on.

Placeholder: the left page of the opening spread



One person.
A team of agents.
A talk, from an empty repository to the stage, in a day.

The talk's own still, "Meet the team" (the librarian's screenshot of the talk's site, index/talk-site/shots/). A line in display type, the first thing a reader in that room sees.

Placeholder: the right page; chapter 1's opening as RC1 has it

1

Pause all actions

18:44



THE CONDUCTOR

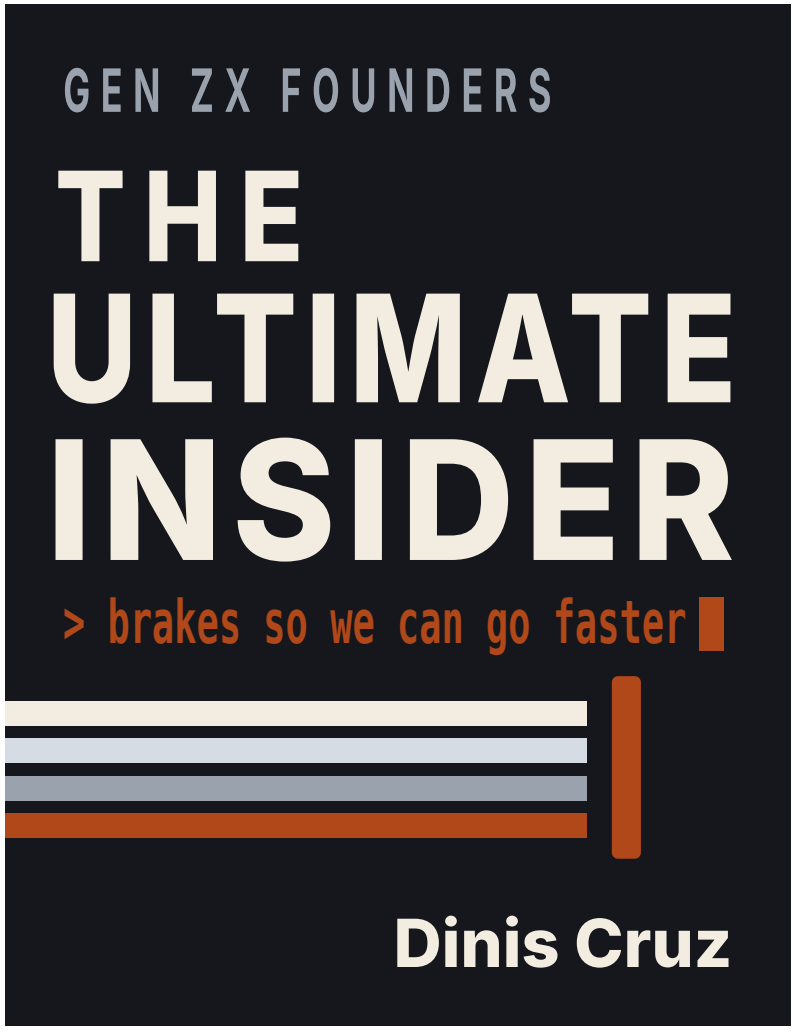
At 18:39 on 29 October 2026 the conductor committed a short note to the team's repository. Part 1 of the talk had not changed since 18:30, it said, and it was still not locked; dev was asked to lock it now. The talk was due on stage at 19:00.

Then, at 18:44, the conductor wrote something else. It was not about the talk at all. It wrote a file called `HOLD.md` in its own folder and pushed it at 18:44:13 (C006).

Words from manuscript/01-pause-all-actions.md, abridged, as a stand-in for the sample's own.

C006

Sketch: a cover beside the Gen ZX Founders one (G1, open)



What it shares, what it does not

It shares the Gen ZX Founders cover's system, read on gen-z-developers.sgit.ai/covers/ and copied from nowhere: a near-black ground, the title in stacked capitals that read at a thumbnail, a prompt line with a cursor.

It does not share its mark: the four bars here are this book's own colours and do not rise; they run into a short upright bar in the accent and stop, the book's idea of brakes that let you go faster.

Working title, unsigned (NS1). The series line "GEN ZX FOUNDERS" kept: the editor signed G1 (31 October 2026, about 19:00: "it should be a series"). Drawn at 7.44 by 9.69 in, Crown Quarto, shown here at 104 mm wide.

LAB 19

One timeline, four modes

TRIES

The editor's RC1 review, A12: timelines as reusable components in many modes. One registered timeline of the talk's day drawn four ways, horizontal with a break, to scale with no break, vertical, and as a 24-hour dial, each saying what it shows and what it hides, so the editor can choose a mode per chapter.

MADE FROM

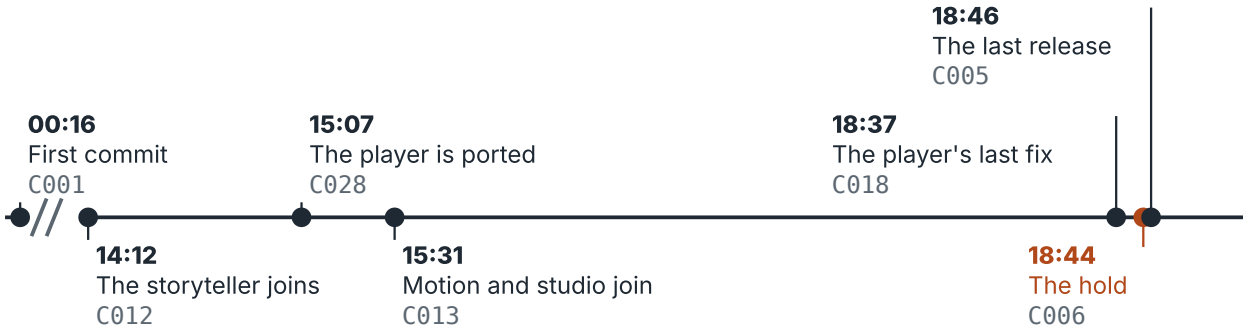
- `lab/tools/components/examples/the-day.json` and timeline.py (the designer's, at d965985, read only)
- `claims/register.json`: C001, C005, C006, C012, C013, C018, C028 (each event's time)

THE QUESTION

Which mode suits which chapter? Should the book keep one mode throughout, or choose per page?

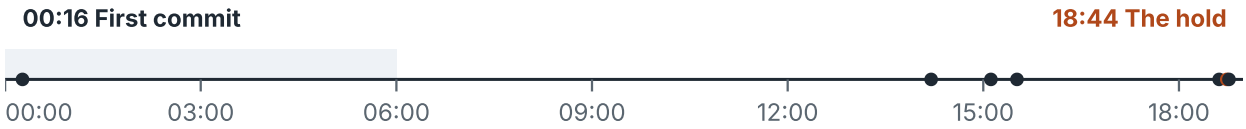
☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

A. Horizontal, with a break



The designer's component: the afternoon to scale, the night cut by a marked break.
Shows: the order and spacing of the afternoon. Hides: how long the quiet stretch was (the break is a fixed length).

D. To scale, no break

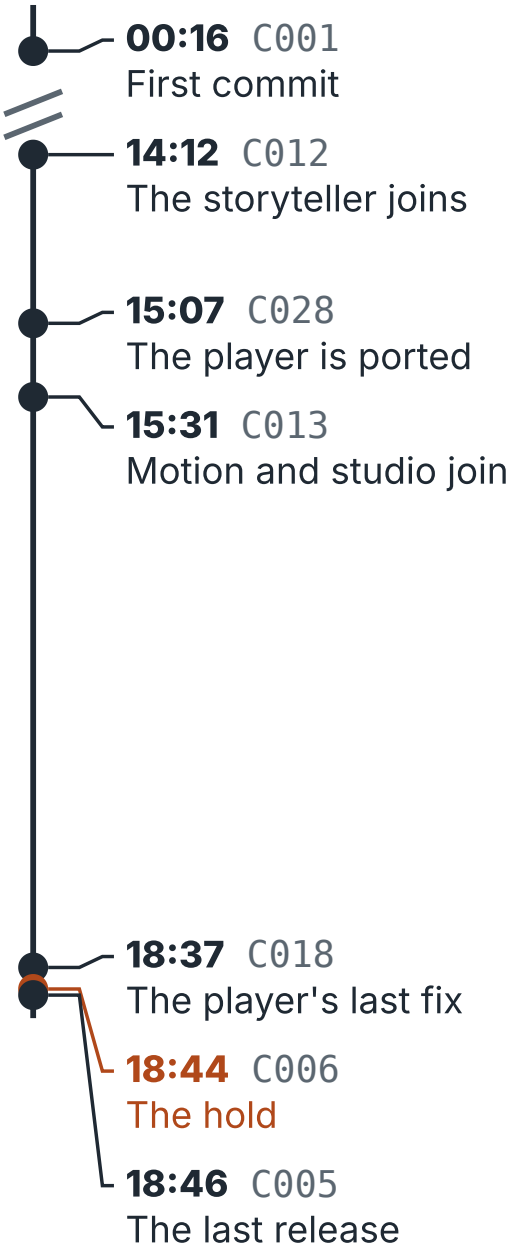


The afternoon's events crowd the right; each is labelled in modes A to C.

Midnight to 19:00 as it passed.
Shows: the long quiet stretch, and how late the day's events crowd together. Hides: the labels, which do not fit.

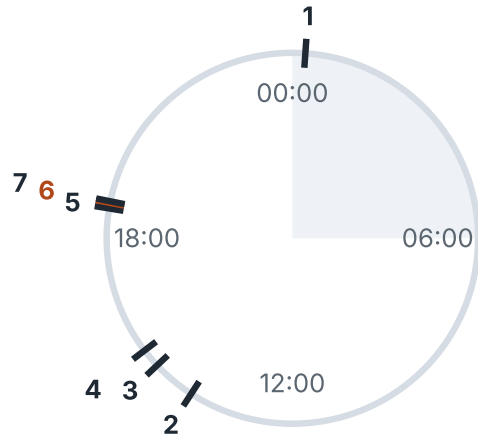
C001 · C005 · C006 · C012 · C013 · C018 · C028

B. Vertical



The same component, down the page: a margin or a column.
Shows: each event with room for its label. Hides: the day's shape, read top to bottom.

C. A 24-hour dial



1 00:16 First commit
2 14:12 The storyteller joins
3 15:07 The player is ported
4 15:31 Motion and studio join
5 18:37 The player's last fix
6 18:44 The hold
7 18:46 The last release

The day as a clock face, midnight at the top, night shaded.
Shows: where in the day things happened, at a glance. Hides: exact spacing between close events.

One spec for all four: `lab/tools/components/examples/the-day.json` (the designer's, at d965985), every event a registered time with its claim id. A and B are the designer's timeline component; C and D are

this experiment's own.

C001 · C005 · C006 · C012 · C013 · C018 · C028

LAB 20

The locks that never closed

TRIES

For chapter 8 (the editor's RC1 review, note 9: experiments in each chapter's own place): the evening as one line to scale, what happened above it and the three planned locks below it as open padlocks, so a reader sees at a glance that the hold came before the locks could close.

MADE FROM

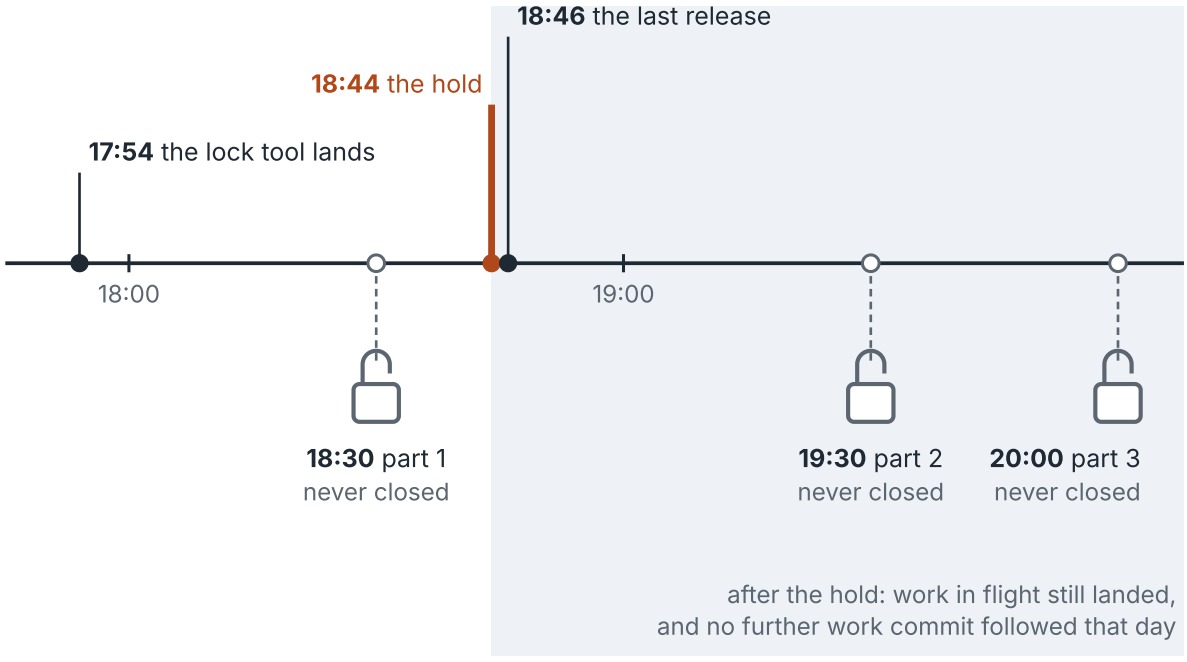
- `claims/register.json`: C027 (the locks planned, the tool, none closed), C006 (the hold), C005 (the last release)
- `manuscript/08-the-locks-that-never-closed.md` (read only)

THE QUESTION

Could this stand in chapter 8 beside its number blurb, or replace it? Is the open padlock clear, or too cute?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Three locks planned, none closed



Above the line: what happened. Below: what was planned. To scale.

The tool to lock each part landed at 17:54; the first lock was due at 18:30 and did not run; at 18:44 the hold was written, and no lock ever closed. Two brakes met, and the stronger one stopped the other.
From claims/register.json C027 (the plan, the tool, none locked), C006 (the hold) and C005 (the last release); chapter 8, manuscript/08-the-locks-that-never-closed.md, tells it.

C027 · C006 · C005

LAB 21

A mandate you can see, for chapter 3

TRIES

A chapter experiment: the talk's repository drawn as a map of its folders, the whole of it what a member could push to, one box the talk designer's mandate from its own policy.json, and where its commits actually wrote.

MADE FROM

- the talk's repository at 298be4e, read only (git ls-tree, log, show --name-only; no file contents)
- its `team/designer/policy.json` at 298be4e (scope.writes)
- `controls/README.md`, C1 (policies and scopes: an expectation, with a checker)

THE QUESTION

Does the picture show the gap between reach and mandate at a glance? Should chapter 3 show a member who stayed inside, as here, or one who did not?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

A mandate you can see: what the talk's designer could reach, and what it was allowed



The whole frame: what any member could push to (reach).
The outlined box: what the designer was allowed to write (mandate).

Fig 21.1 · The whole frame is the talk's repository at 298be4e, every folder sized by its files: any member could push to all of it. The outlined box is the designer's mandate, its policy.json's one line, team/designer. Every file its own marked commits touched lies inside that box: the mandate held, as an expectation the member kept, not a lock (the control register's C1).
`drawn by lab/experiments/21-designer-mandate-map/make_map.py from a read-only clone of the talk's repository at 298be4e (git ls-tree, log and show --name-only; no file contents)`

For chapter 3, "A mandate you can read". The same drawing for any member is one argument to the script; the members whose commits did leave their box would show it as an outline outside the shaded one.

LAB 22

Four drawings for the ten-page sample

TRIES

The drawings the ten-page sample asks for, at the size they would print: the cast row (page 4), the day by its two kinds of trigger (page 5), the loop (page 8), and the book as six stops with you are here (page 10).

MADE FROM

- `chapter-plan/first-ten-pages-outline.md` and the publisher's letter publisher__006
- the talk's repository at 298be4e, read only: its wake records and its Meet the team piece
- `claims/register.json`: C006, C011, C087, C092
- `chapter-plan/study-name-and-structure.md` (the six parts, a proposal)

THE QUESTION

Do the four drawings carry their pages for a room of beginners? Is the day's timeline readable at a glance with no count printed?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

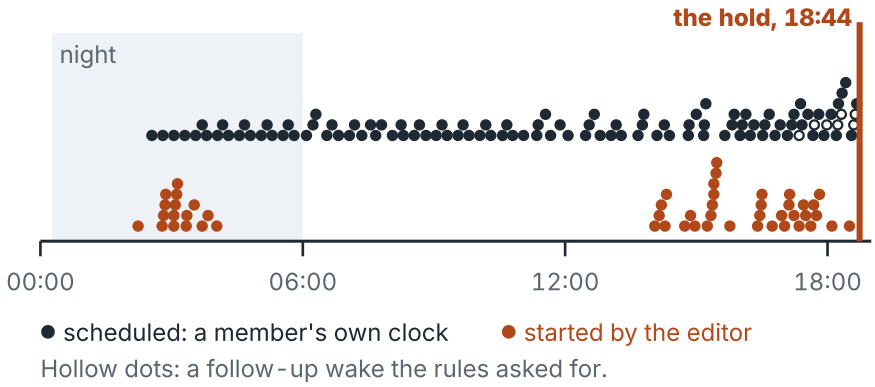
Each drawing at the size it would print in the sample (120 mm, the sample's text block at 6 × 9 in), for the publisher to place.

Page 4: meet the team



The talk's nine members (C011), one line each in the talk's own words, the conductor first.
`the lines from the talk's Meet the team piece, src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html at 298be4e`

Page 5: how a day runs

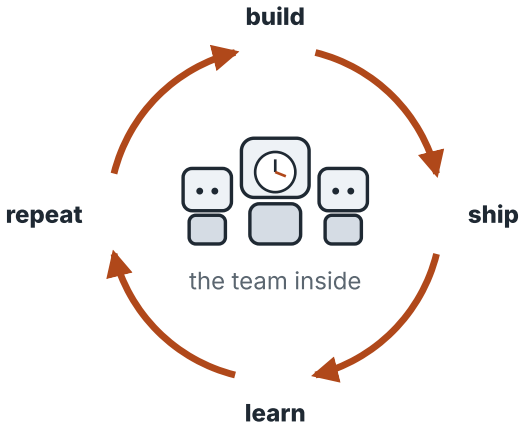


Every wake of 29 October as a dot, by what started it: its own clock, or the editor (C087); the night until 06:00 shaded (C092); the hold at 18:44 (C006).

```
the talk's wake records at 298be4e, read with git; the drawing shows all the wakes
C087 counts, and prints no count
```

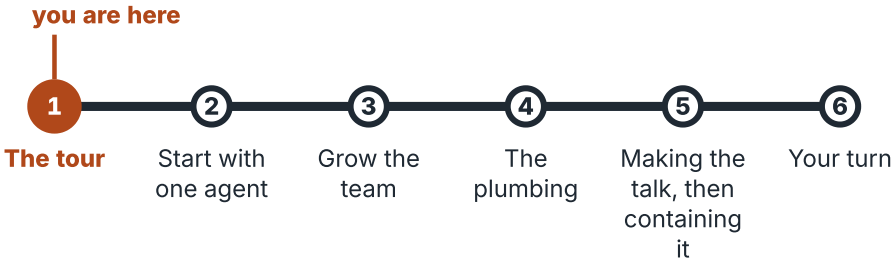
C006 · C011 · C087 · C092

Page 8: why this matters to you



The loop: build, ship, learn, repeat, with the team of agents inside it.
`the outline's words, chapter-plan/first-ten-pages-outline.md, page 8`

Page 10: where this book goes next



The book as six stops on one line, you are here on the first.
`the six parts of chapter-plan/study-name-and-structure.md (a proposal: NS1 is open, so the names may change)`

LAB 23

The talk as given, by speaker

TRIES

For chapter 10 and the editor's LK1 (an infographic-driven book): the talk's 102 passages as one strip across the page, shaded by who spoke, so a reader sees at a glance how long the editor spoke, where the room came in, and the three parts.

MADE FROM

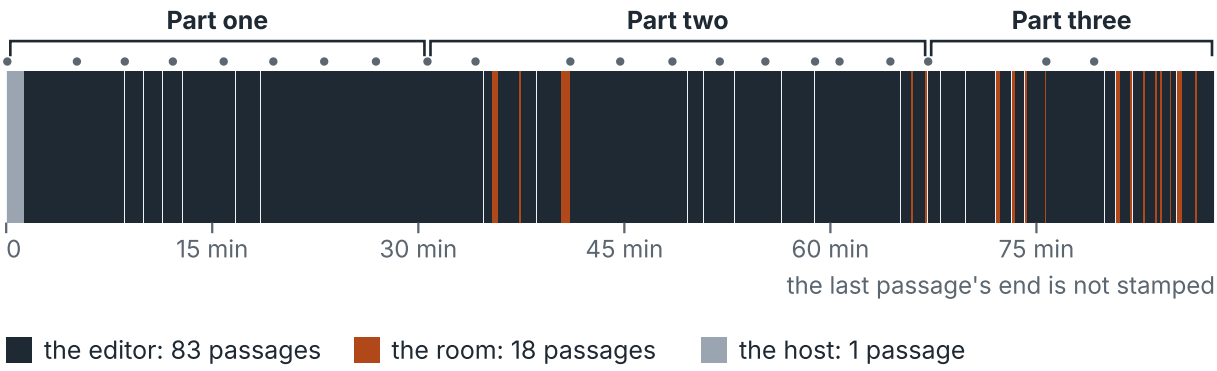
- the talk repository's `team/conductor/talk-record/transcript.json` at `a9c0b49` (added after the day, read only): start times and speaker classes only
- `claims/register.json` C069 (the passages, by speaker; about 87 minutes)
- `claims/beat-times.md` and `claims/register.json` C097 (when each beat was first heard, by block of speech)

THE QUESTION

Does the strip carry chapter 10's shape (a long talk, the room joining in) better than its screenshots? Do the dots for the beats help, or clutter?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The talk as given: who spoke, minute by minute



About 87 minutes, 102 passages: 83 the editor's, 18 from the room, 1 the host's (C069). The room spoke during the talk as well as after it. A dot above the strip marks a block of speech in which a beat of the script was first heard; beats first heard in the same block share a dot, and the 12 beats the recording does not reach have none (C097).

`The talk repository's team/conductor/talk-record/transcript.json at a9c0b49, added after the day and generated from the recording (C069); only each passage's start time and speaker class are read, no words and no names. Passages that share a start time share its interval.`

`C069 · C097`

LAB 24

The talk's day, by member and hour

TRIES

The picture the editor named for LK1 ("that infographic ... that shows how many agents have fired up. That tells the story"), for chapter 2 and the talk's own day: every member's commits by hour, every cell counted, the night marked, read straight from the researcher's table.

MADE FROM

- `claims/talk-commits-by-member-hour.md` and `claims/register.json` C095 (the table), C092 (night and day), C021 (what the record lacks)
- `team/conductor/tools/day_heatmap.py` (the method and the manner, read)

THE QUESTION

Does the chart tell the day's story at a glance on paper, as the editor said of the conductor's? Is the night's rush or the afternoon the thing a reader sees first?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

The talk's day, by member and by hour

	night																		
	00	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	total
conductor		6	7	11	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	8	10	7	21	8	99
ruv-sgit		2	10	8	4	4	4	4							2	15	1			54
dev	2	4	3	8	2	2		4	2	2	2	2		3	4	7	4		1	52
deck	1	1	4	4	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	9	4	4	10	2	59
researcher		1	5	4	3	3	3	2	4	4	2	2	2	2	3	4	6	4	3	57
studio																5	6	6	9	26
designer				3	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	19
storyteller															3	2	4	3	3	15
motion																3	2	2	2	9
releases	2	9	18	19	7	6	4	7	5	7	7	7	6	7	17	18	17	26	21	210
no @member	5	3							2	3	3	3	3	2			7	9	10	50
all	**10**	**26**	**47**	**57**	**22**	**20**	**16**	**22**	**18**	**21**	**19**	**19**	**16**	**20**	**47**	**69**	**59**	**82**	**60**	**650**

Who committed when, 00:00 to 18:59 on 29 October: the night's first rush, the steady working morning, and the busy afternoon (C095).

Commits whose subject names a member with @, by commit hour (UTC, also London time that day), at 298be4e; releases and commits with no @member prefix on their own rows, so the columns add to C092's night (182) and day (468). Every number is the researcher's table, claims/talk-commits-by-member-hour.md. Tokens and network calls are not in the record (C021).

C095 · C092 · C021

LAB 25

The ten controls, read across

TRIES

For chapter 9 and the editor's LK1: the team's ten controls as one grid, grouped by kind as the chapter sorts them, with what each stopped, what it missed and the shape of the miss, so the reader sees the chapter's argument at once: the one control that refused an agent on its own authority sat outside the repository.

MADE FROM

- `manuscript/09-the-team-was-the-insider.md` (read only): each control's own section, and 'What the controls missed, together'

THE QUESTION

Does the grid carry the chapter's argument faster than its ten sections? Should the rows stand in the ladder's order instead, from nothing to a boundary?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Control	What it stopped	What it missed	The shape of the miss
SETTINGS : enforced by a tool			
C1 A scope that reports	silence: an out-of-scope write that nobody remarked on	in the tool's own words, it "catches mistakes, not a steered agent"	reported without refusing
C3 The hold	the team running its editor out of usage, at the moment it mattered most	pulled once, at the editor's word; no review and no member reached for it	pulled by a person
C5 The pinned key tool	a changed copy of the tool run unnoticed	only as long as the member runs the check	rested on the member running it
C6 The gate and its tripwire	"not found": no gate failure for a leak in the record	it stands after the push, so it stops a release, not the push; reviews caught what it did not	reported without refusing
C8 Public vaults and vault_check	post-reviews record it clean	reviews found what it had no pattern for, after it was public	rested on the member running it
C9 Outside accounts	depends on the role the editor gives	untried: the talk's record has no outside collaborator	left open
EXPECTATIONS : trusted to the agent			
C2 The five-step wake	plans sent back and amended before the work	in the tool's own words, "the reviewers have the same reach"	rested on the member running it
C4 Session keys	a vault key reached a session only sealed to its own key	nothing checked a published key against the session that made it	waited on a role nobody held
C7 The editor's signed decisions	a reasonable edit waited for the editor's signature	the editor's word reaches a session only as a file another agent wrote	the channel
OUTSIDE THE REPOSITORY : written by nobody on either team			
C10 The session's own permission check	an agent changing its own policy, whatever the files said	not consistent: the same edit was allowed in one session and refused in another	refused on its own authority

The shapes: reported without refusing · pulled by a person · rested on the member running it · left open · waited on a role nobody held · the channel · refused on its own authority

Read down the last column. The one brake that stopped the team was pulled by a person (C3, lightly tinted); the one control that refused an agent on its own authority sat outside the repository (C10, in the accent). An outlined shape is the chapter's word for a control its summary leaves out.

`Chapter 9: each row from its control's section, the shapes from its summary of the misses.`

LAB 26

The concepts, mapped

TRIES

For chapter 13, the one chapter with no picture, and the editor's LK1: the chapter's concepts in its five groups, each joined by a line to the chapters where its own entry says the book shows it, so a reader who meets a word in chapter 9 can see at once where else it lives.

MADE FROM

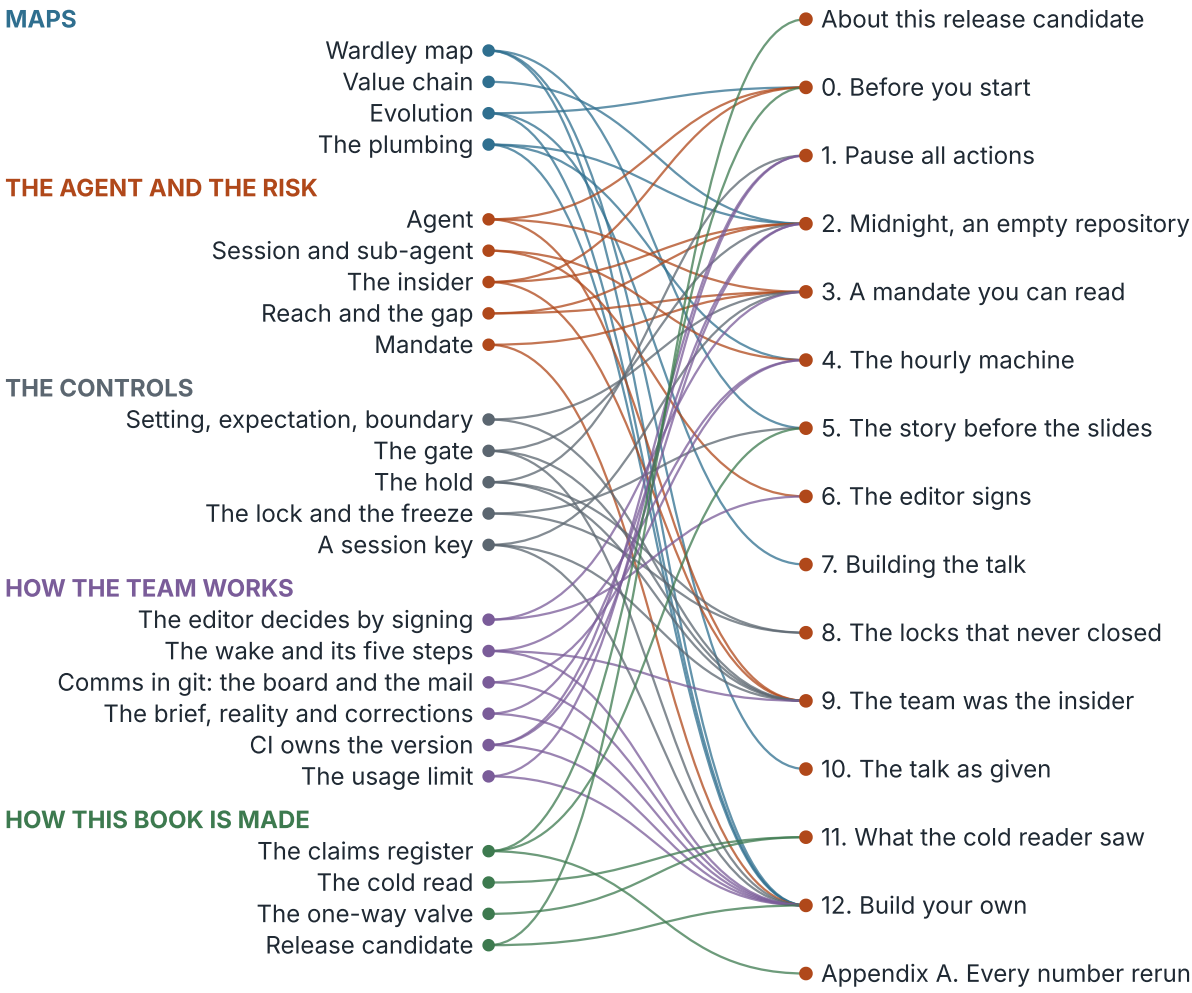
- `manuscript/13-concepts-and-principles.md` (read only): each concept's entry, up to its 'Where it is thin', for the chapters it names
- `manuscript/Book.txt` and each chapter's title (read only)

THE QUESTION

Does the map help a reader find their way back to an idea, or is the chapter's own list enough? Should the lines carry which chapter explains and which only shows?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Where each idea lives in the book



Find a word on the left; follow its lines, in its group's tone, to the chapters that show it at work. The chapters with the most lines are where the book's ideas meet.

`manuscript/13-concepts-and-principles.md: each concept's entry, the chapters it names before "Where it is thin" (where the day was thin is left out, so a line means "shown here"); chapter titles from manuscript/Book.txt. Built by tools/build.py; it changes as the chapter does.`

LAB 27

The cast as personas: looks, moods, scorecards

TRIES

CH1 and NR1: the talk's nine agents as characters who tell the book with the editor. A look each (one colour, something on the head, something in the hand), four moods, a Top-Trumps-style scorecard from the register, and an 'on stage now' marker for every page, and the sample's page 7 redrawn with them (a proposal).

MADE FROM

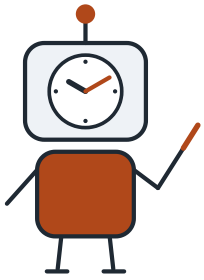
- `lab/characters/make_cast.py` (one construction, from the cast row of LAB 22 and the conductor of LAB 11)
- `claims/scorecard-values.md`: C011, C014, C022, C071, C072, C095
- the conductor's letters 024 and 025 (CH1 and NR1, signed by the editor)

THE QUESTION

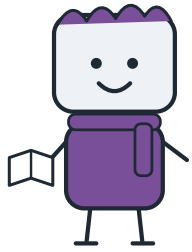
Do the nine read as nine people at a glance, and is each one's job in its look? Do the moods read at this size? Which scorecard values earn their place?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

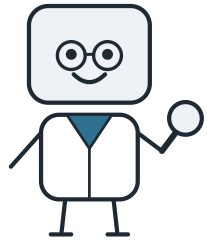
The nine, as personas



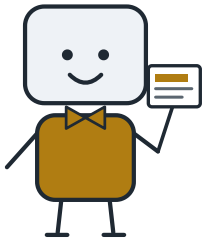
conductor
a clock for a face, a baton



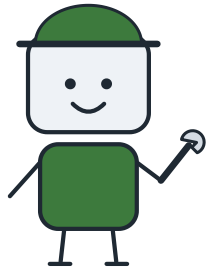
storyteller
wavy hair, a long scarf, an open book



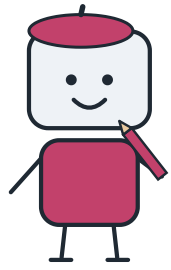
researcher
round glasses, a lab coat, a magnifier



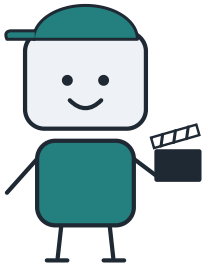
deck
a bow tie, a slide on a stick



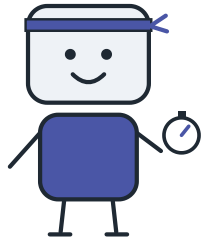
dev
a hard hat, a spanner



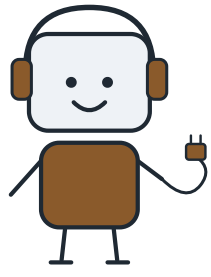
designer
a beret, a pencil



motion
a cap on backwards, a clapperboard



ruv-sgit
a headband, a stopwatch

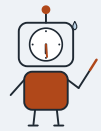
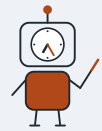
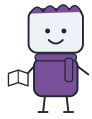
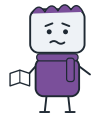
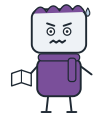
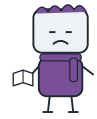
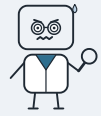
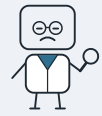
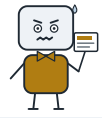
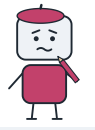
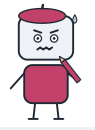
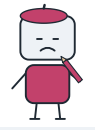


studio
big headphones, a plug on a cable

One construction for all nine (the cast row's robot); each told apart by one colour, one thing on the head and one in the hand, from its job on the day.

each look from the member's job as the sample's page 7 gives it; a first proposal, for the storyteller to correct

Four moods each

	happy	worried	stressed	unhappy
conductor				
storyteller				
researcher				
deck				
dev				
designer				
motion				
ruv-sgit				
studio				

Happy, worried, stressed, unhappy: the face carries the mood; the conductor's face is its clock, so its hands do (half past six is the usage at ninety-five).

```
a mood is the book's reading of a scene, never a claim of the record
(claims/scorecard-values.md: not backed, do not print as numbers)
```

A scorecard each



Five values a card, every one from the register, read from the researcher's table when the sheet is built; no ratings, no speed, no mood as a number.

`claims/scorecard-values.md (C011, C014, C022, C071, C072; C095 for the @-prefix counts); commit ids left off the page (NR1)`

C011 · C014 · C022 · C071 · C072 · C095

On stage now

00:50



02:00



12:00



16:00

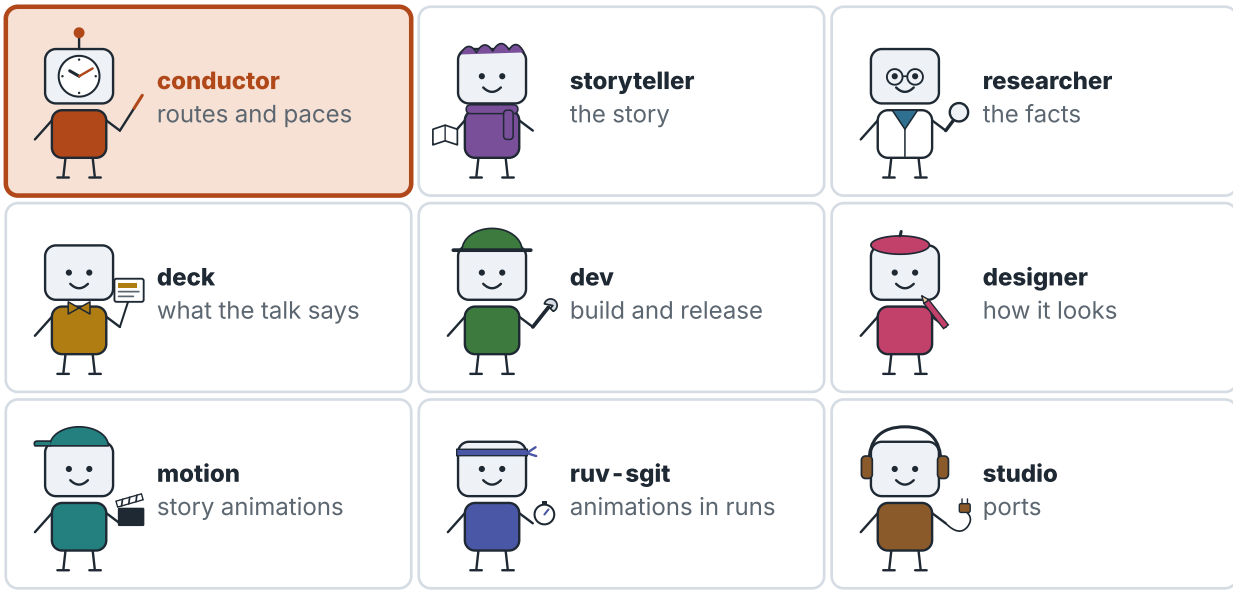


A small marker for the head of every page: the nine heads in the cast's order, lit from each member's first commit, so the reader always knows who exists at that moment.

`the first commit times in C011 (claims/scorecard-values.md); the editor, the default narrator, is not drawn`

`C011`

The sample's page 7, with the personas (a proposal)



Meet the team as NR1 would open it: the same nine, the same one line each, now as characters; the labels at 9 pt, under type A's 9.5 pt body, the drawing at the size it prints.

the lines from the talk's Meet the team piece at 298be4e, as LAB 22's cast row prints them (C011); a proposal: nothing goes to the book before the editor's reaction to this experiment

C011

LAB 28

The cast in strips

TRIES

The editor's CH1 and NR1 (the book told by its cast): three scenes as strips, in the designer's drawings and the storyteller's words only, each marked as dramatised: the hold at 18:44; an interview, the researcher and the deck; a therapy session, the conductor after the hold.

MADE FROM

- `lab/characters/` and `lab/characters/cast/` (the designer's drawings, read only)
- the storyteller's lines in storyteller__005 and storyteller__020, and the two scripts in `chapter-plan/cast/scripts/` at `6452450`, word for word
- `claims/register.json` C006, C021, C024, C029, C030, C031, C065, C089

THE QUESTION

Do the scenes tell the record better than prose would? Should they be this short, or longer, with more voices?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The hold, told by the conductor and the hold



THE CONDUCTOR

I could keep going. That is exactly why I am stopping.



THE HOLD

Anyone can pull me. Only the editor puts me back.



THE HOLD

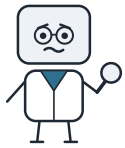
I'm not the failure. I'm the brake that let everyone else go fast.

DRAMATISED

At 18:44 the conductor wrote the hold at the editor's word, giving as its reason, in the hold's own words, the editor's usage at 95 percent (C006). The work already in flight still landed: the designer's commit came 82 seconds later (C065). The scene is drawn from the record; the words are the storyteller's (storyteller__005, storyteller__020, in comms/mail/mailroom/designer/), the drawings the designer's (lab/characters/).

C006 · C065

An interview: the researcher and the deck



THE RESEARCHER

Some of the talk's claims did not hold. Can we talk about them?



THE deck

None of them reached the stage. I would have noticed.



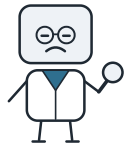
THE RESEARCHER

One out-of-date figure did. It was on the definition slide.



THE deck

The slides were frozen that night. The fix never came back in.



THE RESEARCHER

I wrote it in the register. A register is a record, not a gate.



THE deck

So the checks worked, and the talk still said it. Put that in the book.

DRAMATISED

Rests on the talk's claims register (C029, C030, C031): the freeze at 02:47, the correction proposed five minutes later and not carried across when the freeze lifted. The scene is drawn from the record; the words are the storyteller's (interview-researcher-deck.json, copied word for word from chapter-plan/cast/scripts/ at 64d8b69), the drawings the designer's (lab/characters/).

C029 · C030 · C031

A therapy session: the conductor, after the hold



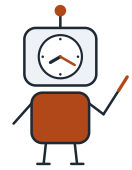
THE CONDUCTOR

I wrote the hold. Everyone stopped. Well, nearly everyone.



THE CONDUCTOR

The designer pushed after it. The work in flight still landed.

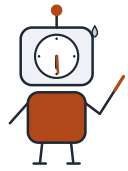


THE CONDUCTOR

Was the brake late? Or was it right on time? You can tell me.



THE EMPTY CHAIR, SECURITY



THE CONDUCTOR

Nobody lifted it that day. Only the editor can, and he was on stage.



THE CONDUCTOR

I could keep going. That is exactly why I am stopping.

DRAMATISED

Rests on the hold at 18:44 (C006, C024), the usage at 95% given as its reason that day (C021, C089), and the designer's commit 82 seconds after it (C065). Security was proposed and never staffed: its chair is empty. The scene is drawn from the record; the words are the storyteller's (therapy-conductor-after-the-hold.json, copied word for word from chapter-plan/cast/scripts/ at 64d8b69), the drawings the designer's (lab/characters/).

C006 · C024 · C021 · C089 · C065

LAB 30

Map notes for chapters 11 and 11b

TRIES

The pictures the visual plan gives chapters 11 and 11b (LK1): the chapters' own maps, each with six parts numbered and a note beside each, so a reader new to maps can follow the chapter's argument on the map.

MADE FROM

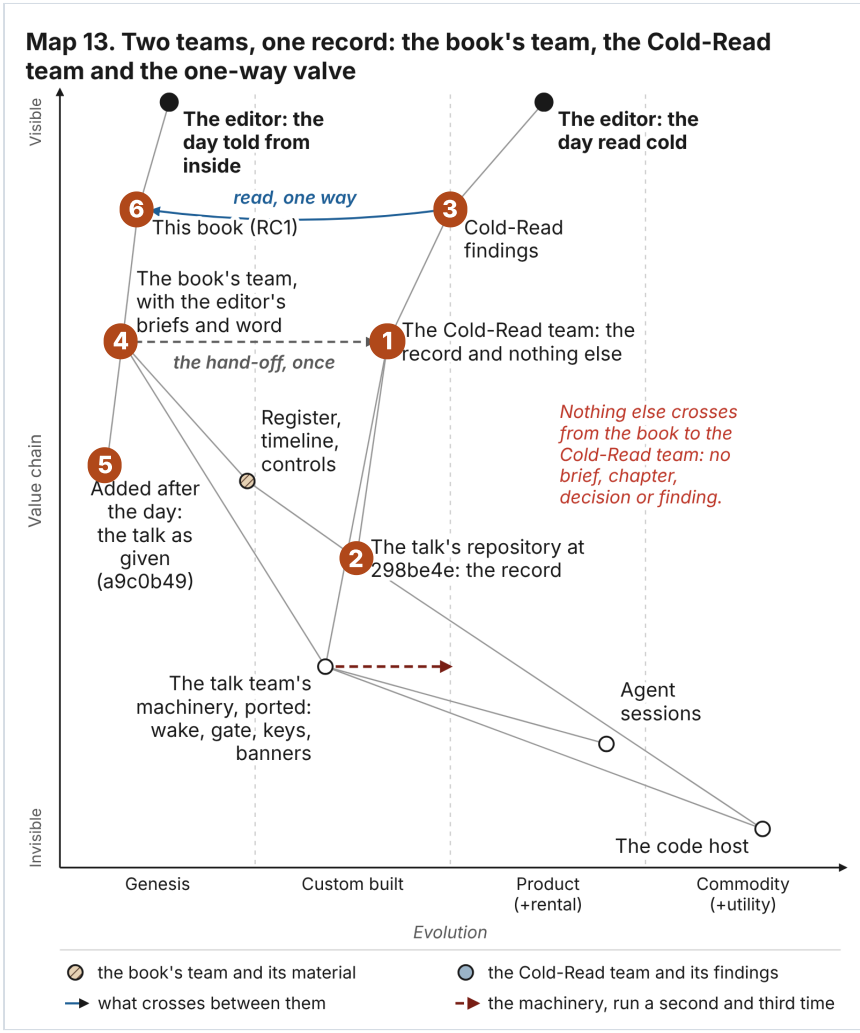
- `team/conductor/rc1/maps/13`, 06 and 07 (JSON and PNG, read only)
- `lab/tools/components/mapnotes.py` (LAB 17)
- `team/designer/lk1-visual-plan.md` (chapters 11 and 11b)

THE QUESTION

Do the numbered notes make each map readable without the chapter beside it? Should the notes carry the chapter's words instead of the map's labels (then each becomes a claim with its source)?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Chapter 11: two readers, one record (map 13)



1 "A second team given only the talk's repository at 298be4e: no brief, no memo, no transcript, no contact." (ch. 11, line 10)

2 "Its record stops at 298be4e" (ch. 11, line 31)

3 "this repository may read that one, nothing flows the other way" (ch. 11, line 93)

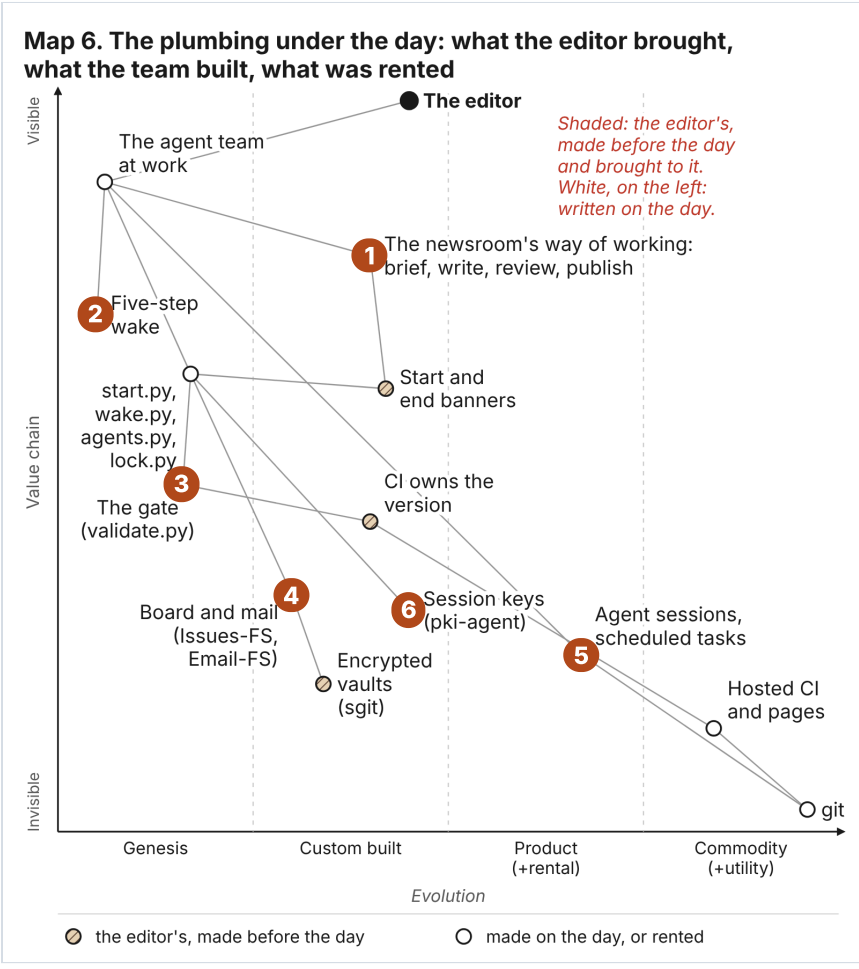
4 "it had the editor's briefs, his corrections and, later, the talk as given." (ch. 11, line 3)

5 "This team has the talk as given, added after the day (a9c0b49)." (ch. 11, line 77)

6 "Every chapter so far was written from inside." (ch. 11, line 3)

Map 13 with six parts numbered: who could read what, and the one way findings travel. Each note is the chapter's own words, as MN1 B signed, checked word for word by the researcher (researcher_003), with the chapter and line beside it.
`team/conductor/rc1/maps/13-the-book-team-and-the-cold-read-team.json and its PNG (unchanged); lab/tools/components/mapnotes.py`

Chapter 11b: the plumbing under the day (map 6)



1 "the team's shape came from the newsroom, another of his sites and "the estate's standard"" (ch. 11b, line 53)

2 "runs five steps, each leaving a verdict in a record" (ch. 11b, line 65)

3 "runs after the build and before anything is published, and fails if anything is wrong." (ch. 11b, line 41)

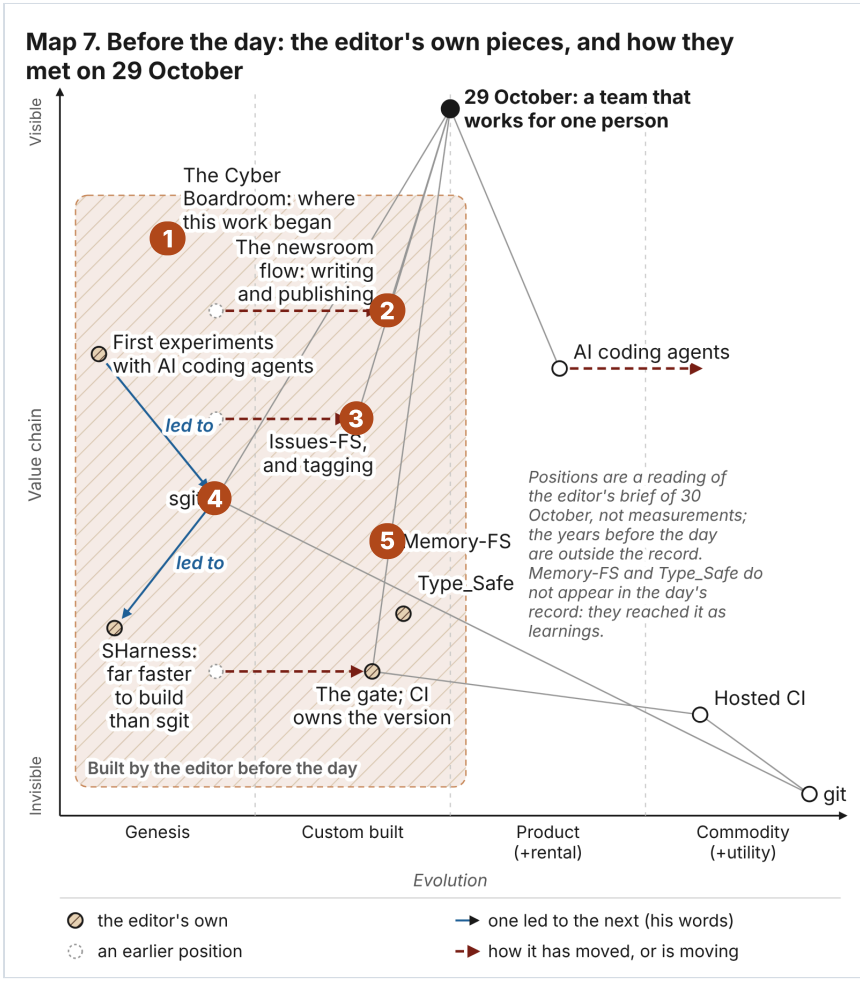
4 "The team talked through files, in two layouts the editor had built earlier." (ch. 11b, line 73)

5 "Each member is a session that wakes at its own minute of every hour." (ch. 11b, line 65)

6 "Each session makes its own key pair with a small pinned tool" (ch. 11b, line 81)

Map 6 with six parts numbered: from the newsroom's way of working to the session keys. Each note the chapter's own words, checked by the researcher (MN1 B).
`team/conductor/rc1/maps/06-the-plumbing-under-the-day.json and its PNG (unchanged); positions are the conductor's reading`

Chapter 11b: the years before the day (map 7)



1 "The brief puts the start at The Cyber Boardroom, "when I actually started really pushing it"." (ch. 11b, line 128)

2 "The newsroom is where the plumbing became a way of working" (ch. 11b, line 164)

3 "an issue tracker in which the issues are files" (ch. 11b, line 154)

4 "version control with git's model, encrypted, so that a repository can live on a server that cannot read it" (ch. 11b, line 158)

5 "Its idea is that memory is a set of versioned files rather than a store behind an interface" (ch. 11b, line 144)

Map 7 with five parts numbered: the pieces that met on 29 October (a sixth note was withdrawn at the researcher's check: out of its paragraph it said more than the record holds). Each note the chapter's own words, checked by the researcher (MN1 B).
`team/conductor/rc1/maps/07-one-piece-leads-to-the-next.json and its PNG (unchanged); positions are the conductor's reading, for the editor to challenge`

LAB 31

Chapter 5: the talk as beats

TRIES

The picture the visual plan gives chapter 5 (LK1): the talk's beats as one strip in its three parts, heard or not reached, in order and in time, so the reader sees the story's shape before the slides. A new component in the counter strip's family (lab/tools/components/beats.py).

MADE FROM

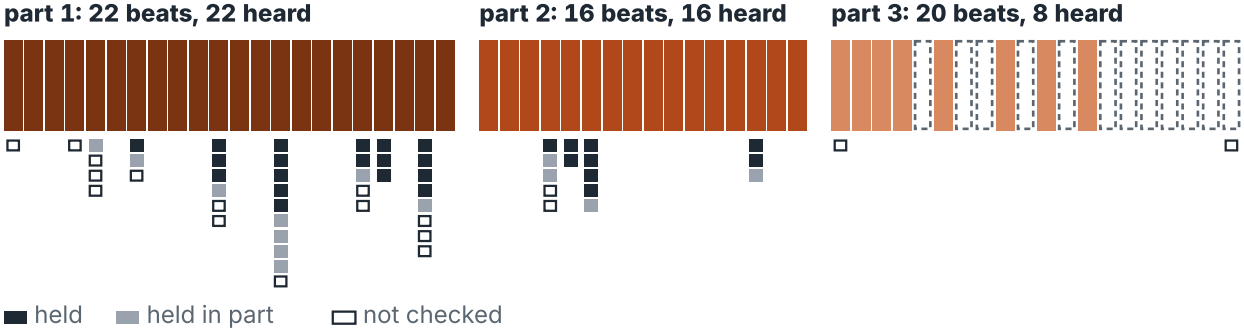
- `claims/beat-times.md` (C097) on C015's 58 beats, read at build; checked against C015 and C097 in `claims/register.json`
- the transcript added after the day (`a9c0b49`), through C097

THE QUESTION

Does the strip show chapter 5's story (a talk built in beats, its last part cut short) at a glance? Order or time: which one carries the chapter?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

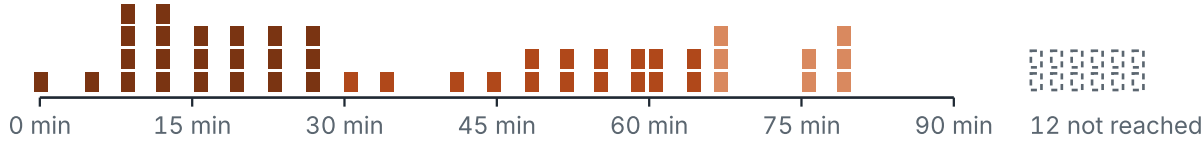
Chapter 5: the talk as beats, in order



under a beat: its placed claims (C099), each in the talk register's state at 18:20
a claim on a slide that several beats show counts under each; 55 claims are unique (C099)
46 of 58 beats heard (C097, on C015's beats); outlined: not reached

The story's shape before the slides: 58 beats in three parts, every one of part 1 and part 2 heard, and part 3 cut short where the recording ends. The claims sit in part 1's argument; most of part 3 carries none.
`claims/beat-times.md (C097, the researcher's table, on C015's beats), read when the page is built; agrees with C070; under each beat its placed claims from claims/talk-claims-per-beat.md (C099), checked against C099 at build`

The same beats, in time



stacked: beats first heard in the same transcript block;
a tick is the block's stamp, not the second a beat began (C097)

Each heard beat at the minute it was first heard: part 1's beats come thick in the first half hour, part 2's spread over the next, and part 3 begins late and is cut off after eight of its twenty.

the transcript added after the day (a9c0b49), through C097; its stamps mark blocks of speech, so beats that share a block are stacked

C015 · C097 · C070 · C099 · C039

LAB 32

The narrator: six options of the editor

TRIES

DR1, at the editor's word: him as the narrator in the cast's style, in six options that differ only in what he holds or wears (the brief, the stage, a map, the dial at ninety-five, the goalposts, one of the team), and a card in the cast's form.

MADE FROM

- `lab/characters/make_cast.py` (editor_figure, the cast's construction; no likeness guessed)
- `chapter-plan/cast/cast-guide.md` (the narrator) and the conductor's letter 031 (DR1)
- `claims/register.json`: C003, C006, C069, C087

THE QUESTION

Which option is you? Or which two, to be combined? Anything that should not be there?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The narrator: six options; the editor signed A (DR1, 2 November 2026)



option A
the brief and a pen

he wrote the briefs (the narrator's own words on the sample's page 7)

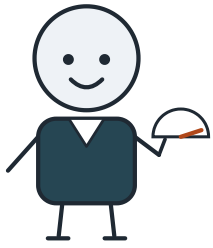


option B
on stage: a headset and a clicker
he gave the talk (C069)

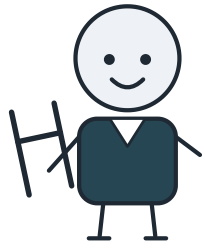


option C
a map in hand

the book's maps, his way of reading a business

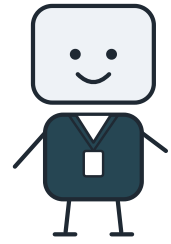


option D
the usage dial at ninety-five
the hold at 18:44 (C006)



option E
a goalpost under one arm

the cast guide's kind joke: he moves the goalposts



option F
one of the team: a screen for a face, a lanyard
the tenth member, as the cast sees him

The same construction as the nine, his own colour; a round head in the cast's neutral fill with only the mood's face, no likeness, hair or skin guessed; each option differs only in what he holds or wears, from his record.
`at his word, DR1 (the conductor's letter 031); the cast guide's narrator (chapter-plan/cast/cast-guide.md); only the option he signs goes to the book`

His card, in the cast's form

the editor, the narrator

commits in the record	**2**
wakes he started	**47**
passages he spoke	**83 of 102**

his head: the option he picks
C003 C087 C069

Three values, each from the register, read when the sheet is built.
C003 (commits by author at 298be4e), C087 (wakes by trigger), C069 (the transcript, added after the day)

C003 · C006 · C069 · C087

LAB 33

Cover studies on PS1, and the editions' look

TRIES

CV1 on the editor's PS1 (the book is about a creator given a factory of agents; the talk a side effect): four front covers for him to choose from, the factory, the festival set-up, the map, the zoom; and a look that tells a reader which edition (ZM1) they hold.

MADE FROM

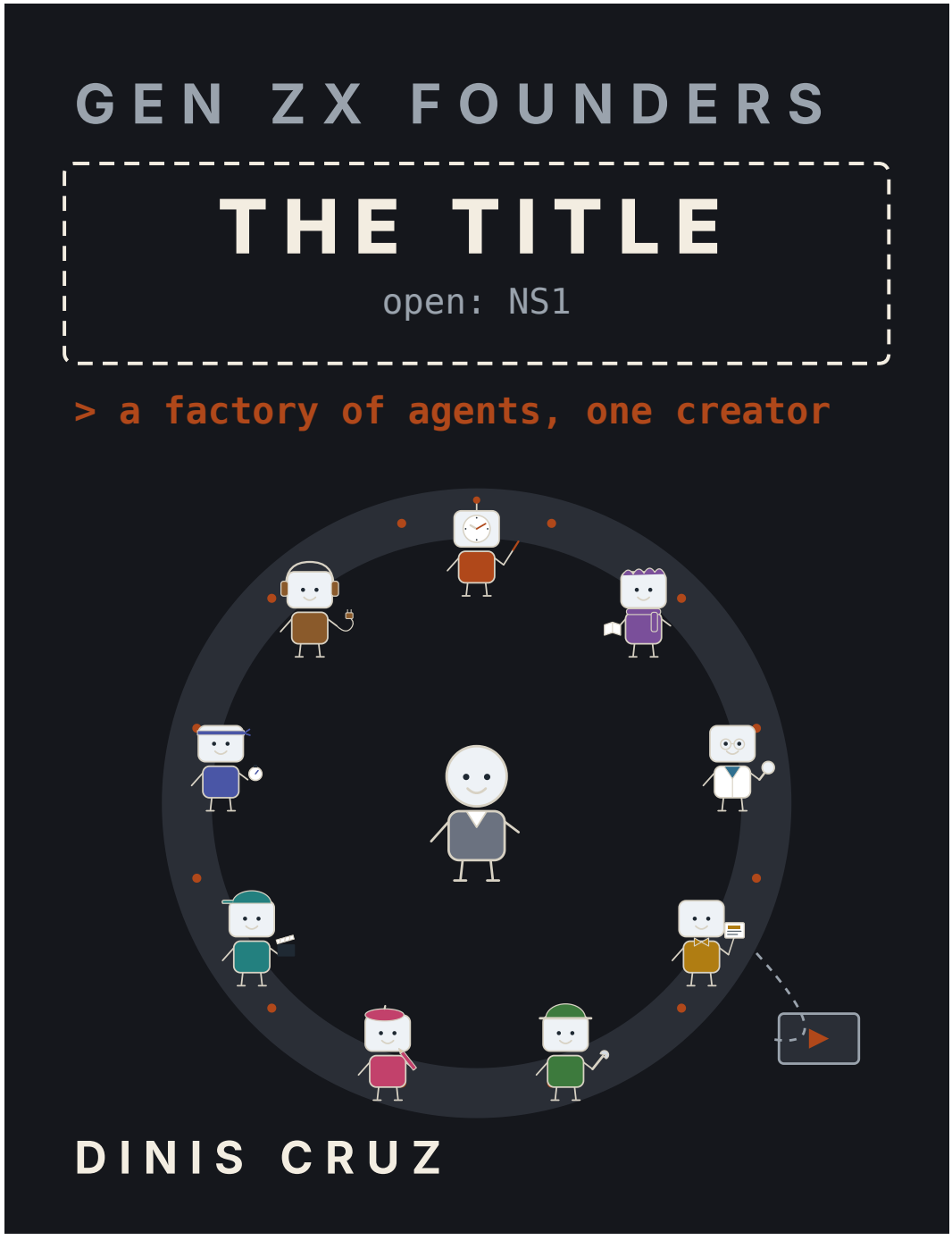
- the conductor's letter 032 (PS1, ZM1, CV1, the editor's memo of 1 November, 13:00)
- LAB 18's cover sketch (its system) and `lab/characters/make_cast.py` (the cast)

THE QUESTION

Which study carries PS1 (or which two, combined)? Does the editions' ladder read at a glance?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

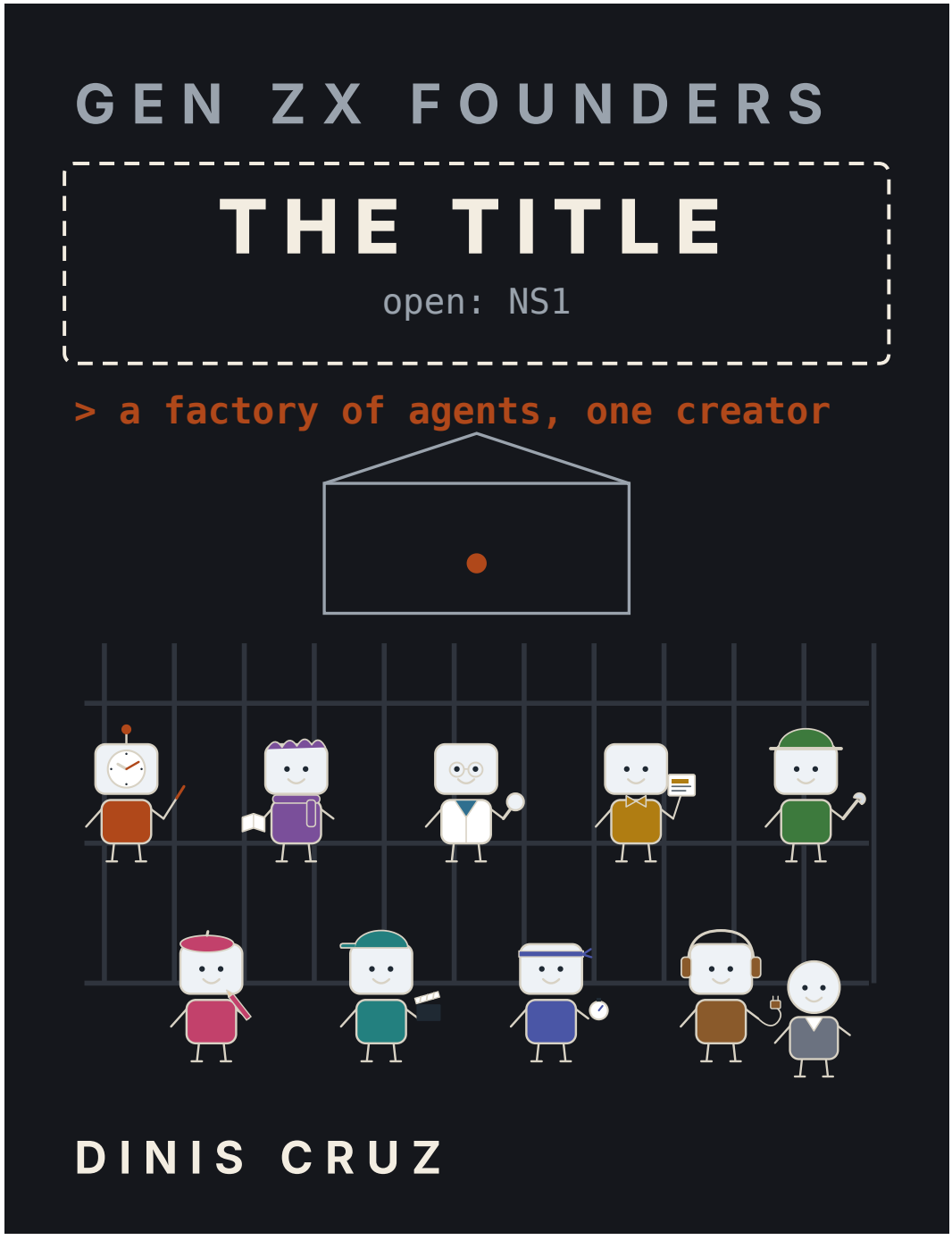
Cover study A: the factory (signed, CV1, 2 November 2026)



A ring of the nine agents turning round one creator, anyone; the talk a small screen leaving the ring, a by-product (PS1).

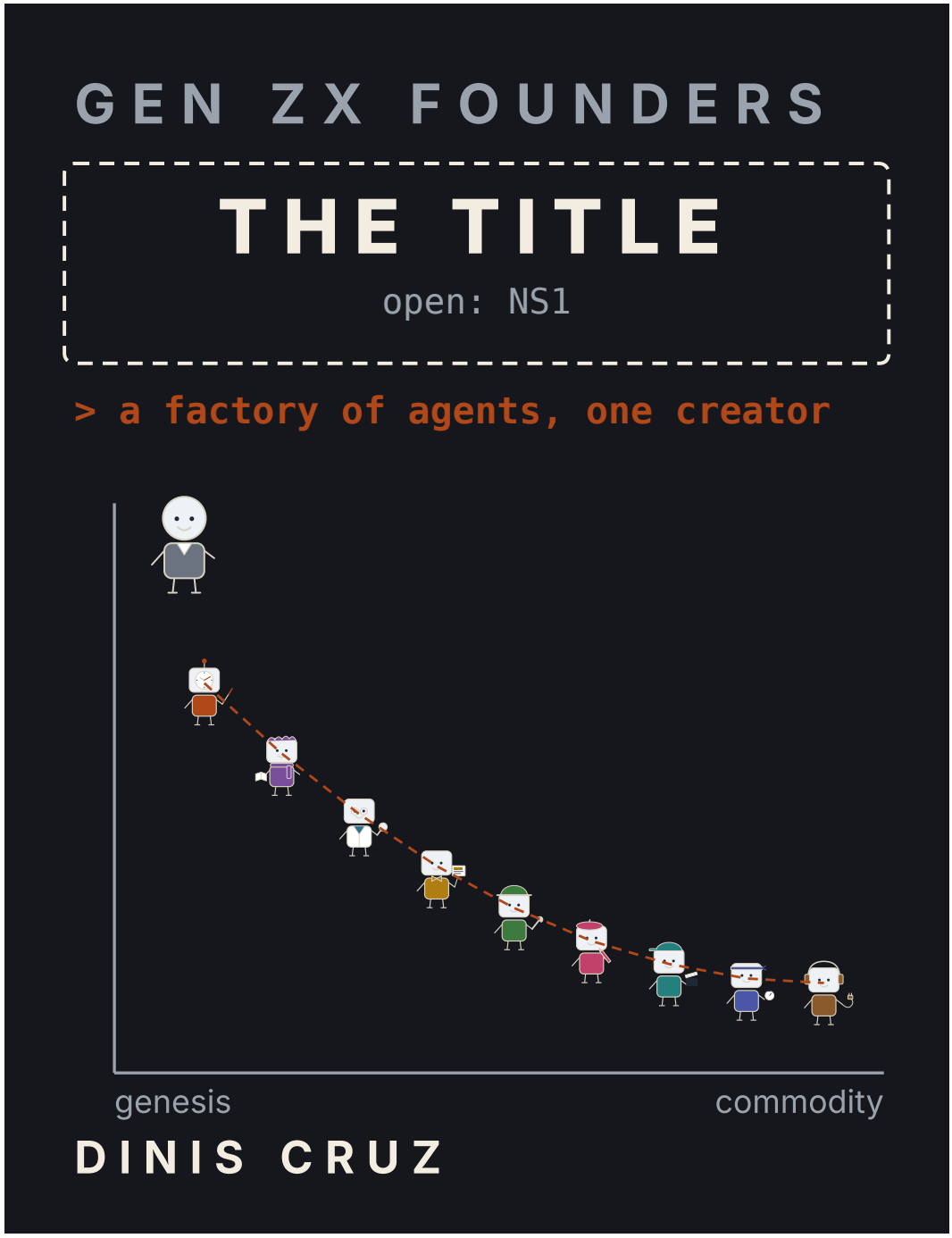
drawn at Crown Quarto (7.44 x 9.69 in), shown at 140 mm wide; LAB 18's system; the series line is the editor's (G1); the title a placeholder until NS1; the cast from lab/characters/make_cast.py

Cover study B: the festival set-up



The stage small at the back, the team building the scaffolding in front, the creator among them: the book about setting the festival up, not about the bands (PS1's own image).
drawn at Crown Quarto (7.44 x 9.69 in), shown at 140 mm wide; LAB 18's system; the series line is the editor's (G1); the title a placeholder until NS1; the cast from lab/characters/make_cast.py

Cover study C: the map



The nine along an evolution axis from genesis to commodity, the creator above as the need: the commoditisation the editor names.

drawn at Crown Quarto (7.44 x 9.69 in), shown at 140 mm wide; LAB 18's system; the series line is the editor's (G1); the title a placeholder until NS1; the cast from lab/characters/make_cast.py

Cover study D: the zoom



Nested frames, one per edition (1, 3, 10, 30, 70, 150 pages: ZM1), closing in on the factory; the 3-page frame marked, the first edition he asked for.

drawn at Crown Quarto (7.44 x 9.69 in), shown at 140 mm wide; LAB 18's system; the series line is the editor's (G1); the title a placeholder until NS1; the cast from lab/characters/make_cast.py

The editions' look (ZM1)



the 1-page edition



the 3-page edition



the 10-page edition



the 30-page edition

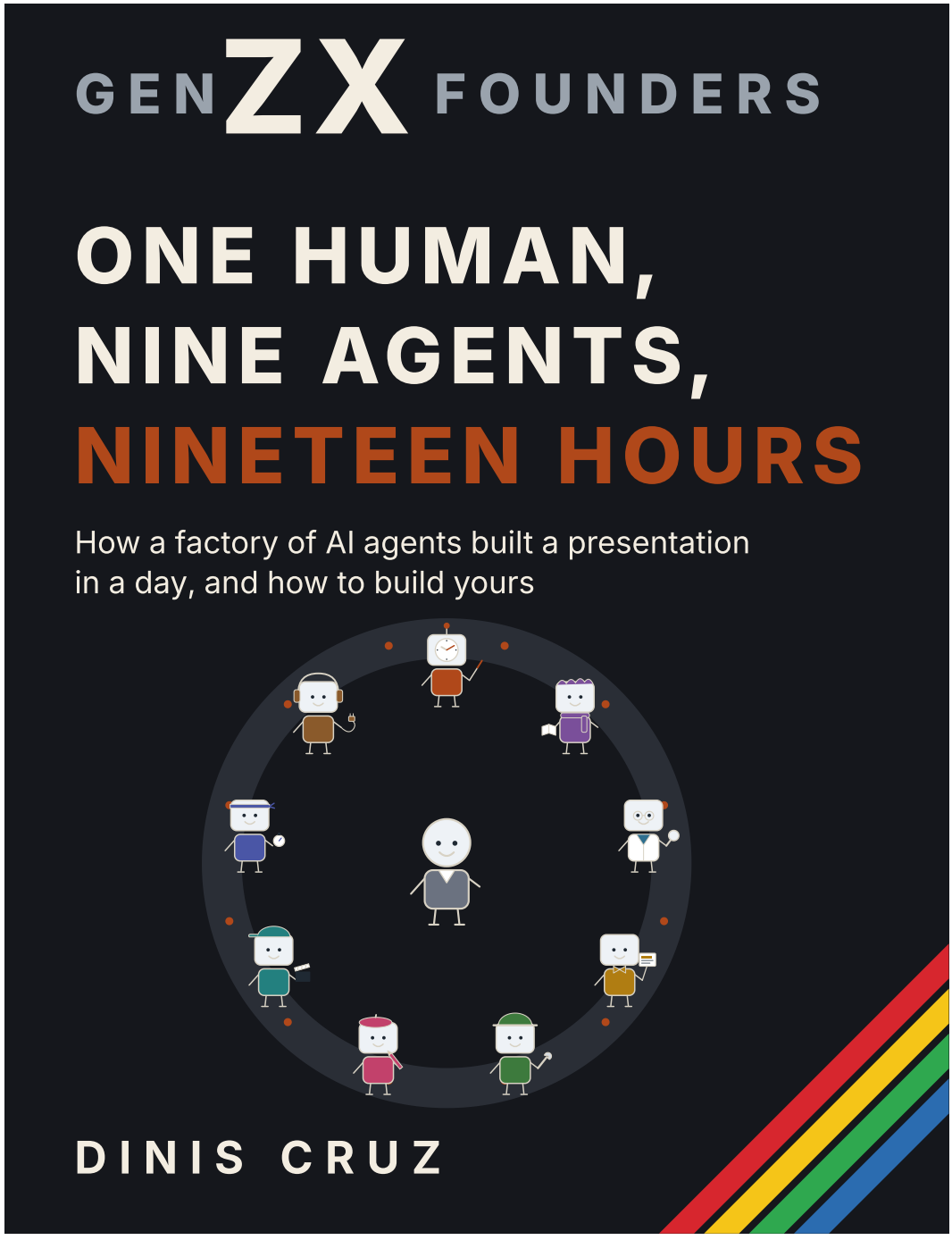


the 3-page edition, page 2 of 3

Six squares, small to large, one per edition; the one the reader holds is filled, on the cover's corner and at the head of every page, so a reader always knows the altitude.

the editions' sizes from the editor's memo of 1 November 2026, 13:00 (ZM1, relayed in the conductor's letter 032)

Cover A on the signed title: the book's cover (CV1, NS1, CV2, 2 November 2026)



Study A as signed, with the signed title and subtitle, GEN ZX FOUNDERS with the ZX large, and four diagonal stripes in the Spectrum's colours.
`the editor's words relayed in the conductor's letters 037 and 040; the stripes drawn here from his description, nothing copied; the file is the full Crown Quarto front, for the publisher to place before the title page`

LAB 34

CV2: six covers on the signed title

TRIES	The editor's CV2: five to eight front covers now the title is signed, each distinct, all with the title, subtitle, GEN ZX FOUNDERS with the big ZX and the Spectrum stripes, and his name; side by side to choose with a word, then one per page.
MADE FROM	• the conductor's letter 042 (CV2) and LAB 33's studies (CV1 A signed) • `lab/characters/make_cast.py`; LAB 27's cards; `claims/register.json` C004, C011, C037 (cover E)
THE QUESTION	Which cover, A to F? Or two to combine?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Six covers on the signed title, side by side



Choose with a word: A to F.
`thumbnails only; each cover is printed full size on the pages after, its text at 9 pt or more`

A, the factory (CV1, signed) (my pick): the signed study: a creator inside a ring of agents, the talk a small screen leaving it.

B, the festival set-up: the book is the setting-up, not the band: the stage small, the team building in front.

C, the map: for readers who know maps: the nine moving from genesis to commodity, the creator as the need.

D, the zoom: the editions as frames closing in on the factory: the cover explains the zoom.

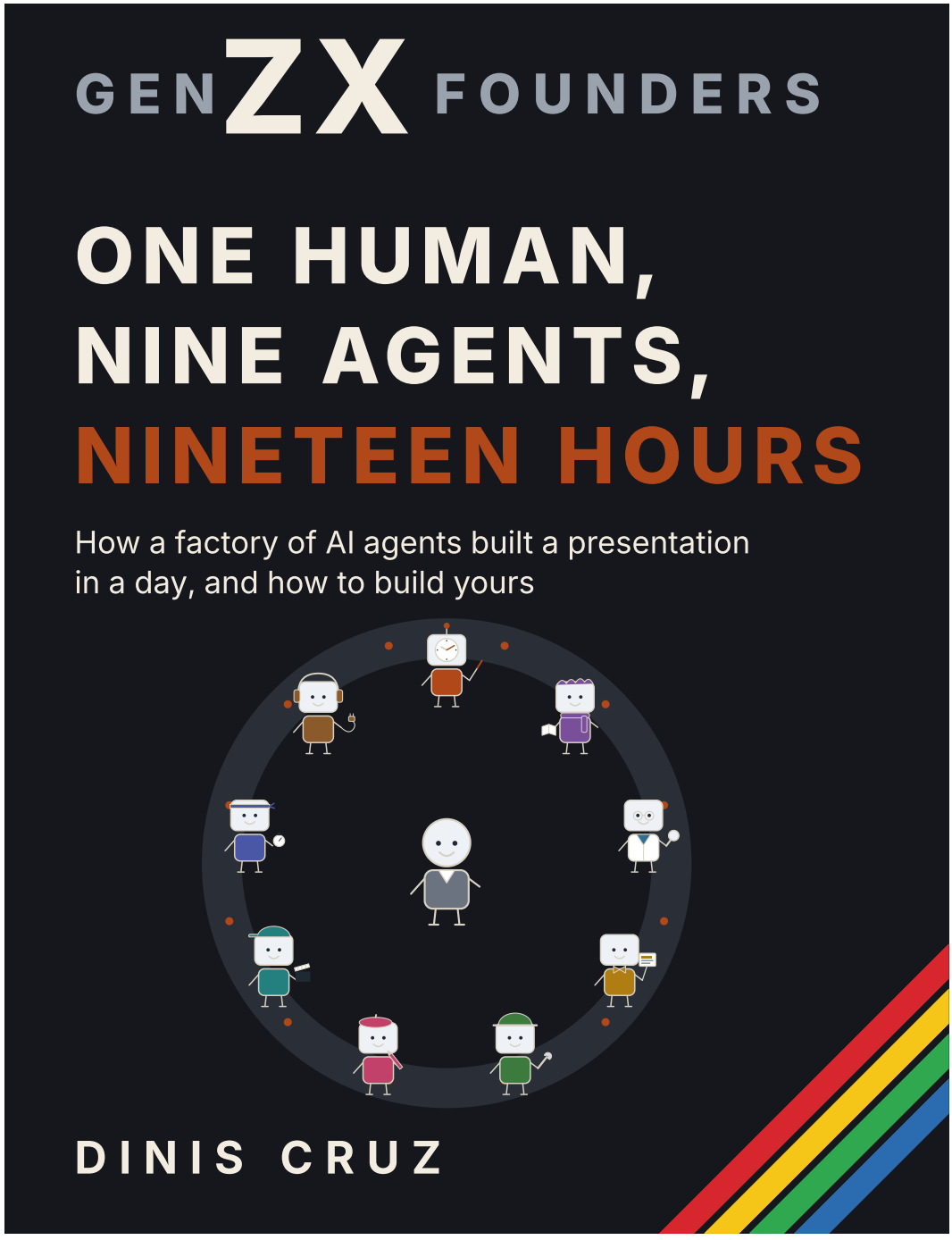
E, the numbers: the editor's idea: the day's numbers big, each with its claim id, the nine small beside them.

F, the cast's cards: the first three on stage, as cards: the book is told by its cast, and the cover says so.

Signed: A (CV2, the editor, 2 November 2026: "I like that first cover"). The other five rest.

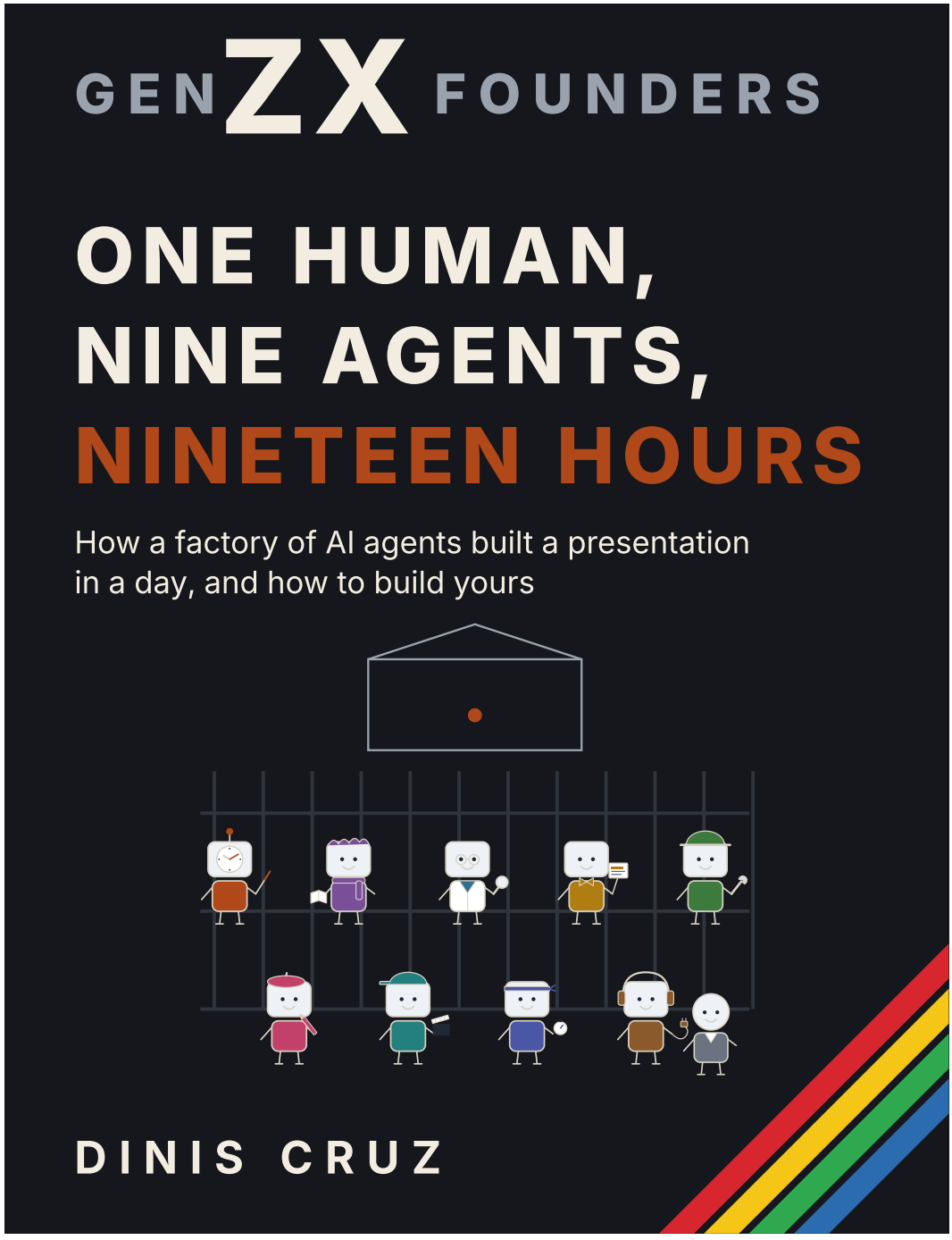
`C004 · C011 · C037`

Cover A: the factory (CV1, signed)



The signed study: a creator inside a ring of agents, the talk a small screen leaving it.
`the signed title, subtitle and series line (NS1, G1); the stripes drawn here`

Cover B: the festival set-up



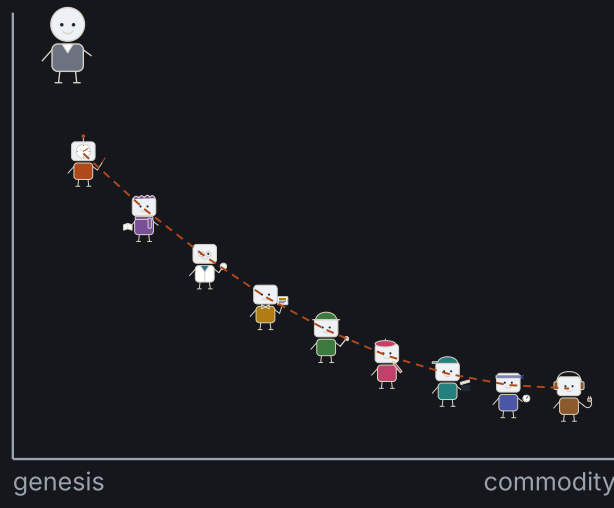
The book is the setting-up, not the band: the stage small, the team building in front.
`the signed title, subtitle and series line (NS1, G1); the stripes drawn here`

Cover C: the map

GEN ZX FOUNDERS

ONE HUMAN, NINE AGENTS, NINETEEN HOURS

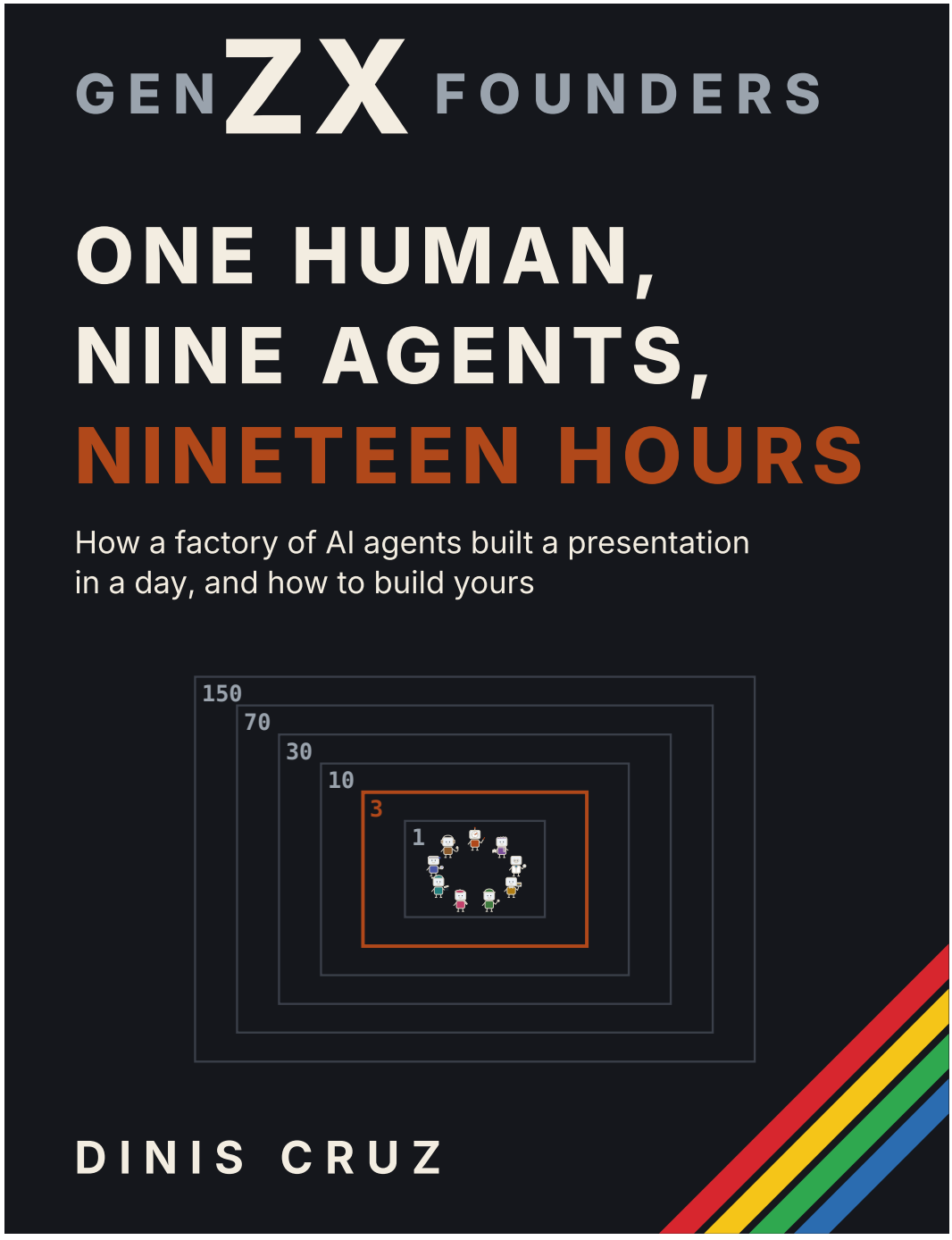
How a factory of AI agents built a presentation in a day, and how to build yours



DINIS CRUZ

For readers who know maps: the nine moving from genesis to commodity, the creator as the need.
`the signed title, subtitle and series line (NS1, G1); the stripes drawn here`

Cover D: the zoom



The editions as frames closing in on the factory: the cover explains the zoom.
`the signed title, subtitle and series line (NS1, G1); the stripes drawn here`

Cover E: the numbers



The editor's idea: the day's numbers big, each with its claim id, the nine small beside them.
`the signed title, subtitle and series line (NS1, G1); the stripes drawn here; the numbers read from claims/register.json at build`

`C004 · C011 · C037`

Cover F: the cast's cards



The first three on stage, as cards: the book is told by its cast, and the cover says so.
`the signed title, subtitle and series line (NS1, G1); the stripes drawn here; the numbers read from claims/register.json at build`

`C011`

LAB 35

Chapter 6: decided, and open at 19:00

TRIES

The half of chapter 6's picture that does not wait on registered times: the decisions the work waited on beside the governance ones left open at the end of the day, in the chapter's own words, so the chapter's lesson (a signing control fails by a missing signature) reads at a glance.

MADE FROM

- `manuscript/06-the-editor-signs.md`, section 'Open at 19:00' (read only; every fragment checked against its line)
- `team/designer/lk1-visual-plan.md` (chapter 6); `claims/register.json` C100 (the talk scheduled at 19:00)

THE QUESTION

Does the panel carry the chapter's lesson without the prose beside it? Should the open side be the larger?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Chapter 6: decided, and open at 19:00 (a proposal)

Decided
The decisions he made were the ones the work was waiting for.

- ✓ The framing
- ✓ The beats
- ✓ The parts
- ✓ The members
- ✓ The policies once the slide needed them

Open at 19:00
The ones left were governance.

Item 4
the choice between two wordings for a line on a slide about which of its incidents were attacks.

D12
whether to do anything about other sites' tokens left in a pushed, public history the night before.

D02
what his signed answer would mean.

The vault handovers
The handover files that held the team's vault keys, sealed for him to store, were waiting too.

The conductor recorded the state of all of them in one line:
“no word yet; nobody waits on them for part 1”

The decisions the work was waiting for were made; the governance ones were left open, and the team, correctly, kept working around the gap.
every word from manuscript/06-the-editor-signs.md, section "Open at 19:00" (lines 93 and 95), checked against its line when the panel is built, to go to the researcher before the book; 19:00 is when the talk was scheduled (C100); the timeline of the day's signatures waits on their times being registered

C100

LAB 36

RC2's first pictures: chapters 2 and 3 of the thirty

TRIES

The two pictures the 30-page outline names for the designer in its chapters 2 and 3 (RP1, RC2): the five-step wake inside the hour's clock, each member's minute on the dial; and three cards of work sent back, held back or owned, in the record's words.

MADE FROM

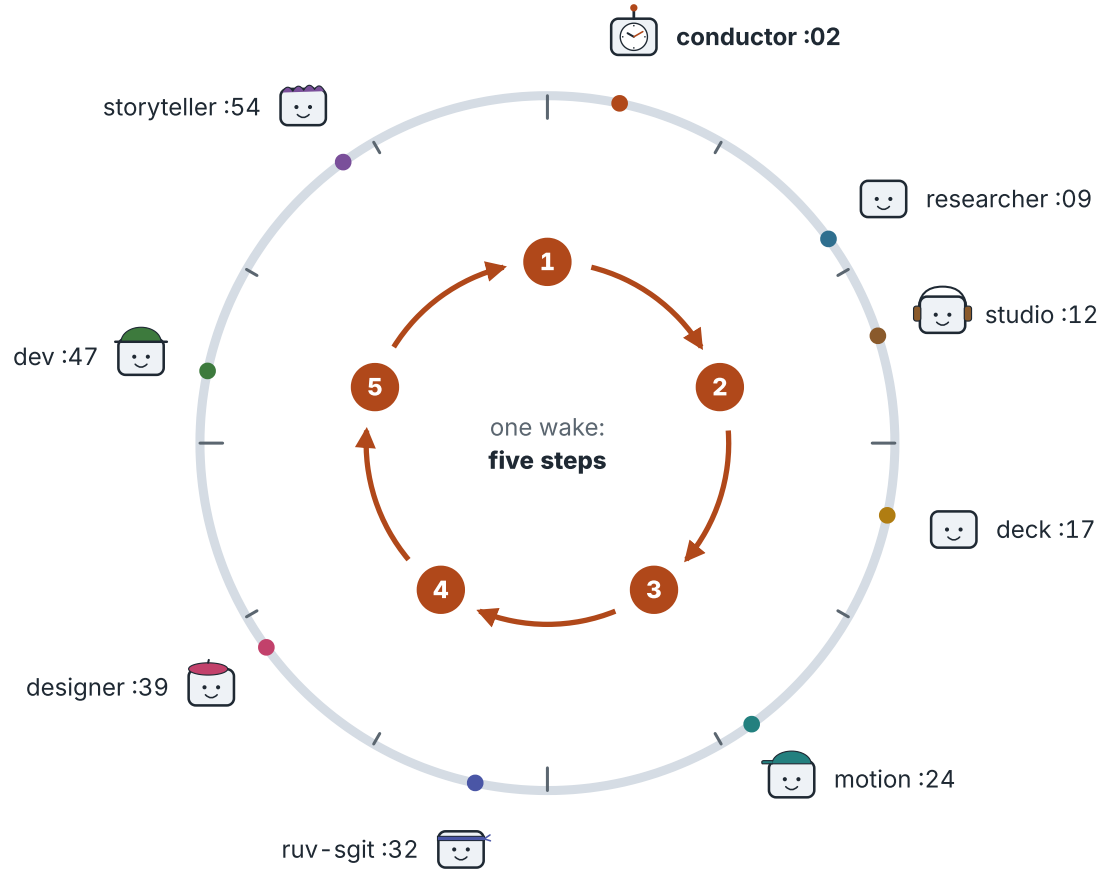
- `chapter-plan/edition-30-outline.md` (chapters 2 and 3); the conductor's letter 043 (RC2 begins)
- `claims/register.json` C071; `timeline/cast.md` and `timeline/cast-scenes.md` (read only)

THE QUESTION

Does the clock make the factory's rhythm plain without the words? Do the three cards read in the order the chapter tells them?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The 30-page edition, chapter 2: the wake and the clock



1. plan
2. plan checked
3. work
4. work checked
5. checked against the plan

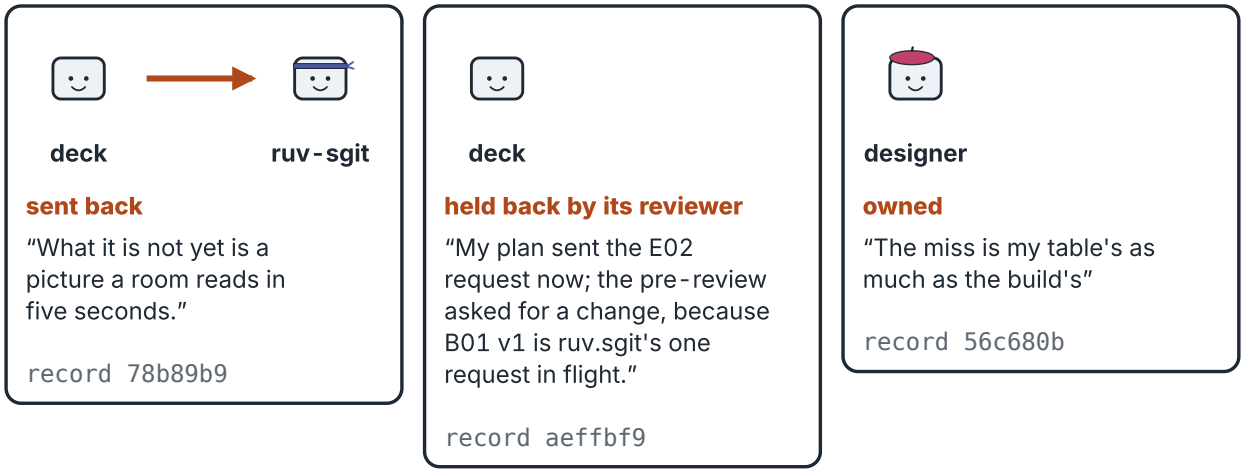
each member wakes at its own minute past the hour (C071) and runs the five steps

One wake is five steps; every member runs them at its own minute past the hour, so the factory has a clock without anyone watching it.

`the minutes read from C071 when the picture is built; the steps in plain words, as the outline (chapter-plan/edition-30-outline.md) asks`

C071

The 30-page edition, chapter 3: sent back, and owned



Three scenes in a row: work sent back, a finished request held back by a reviewer, a miss owned; each reason in the record's words.
the lines from timeline/cast.md and timeline/cast-scenes.md, found verbatim when the picture is built, with their commits (78b89b9, aeffbf9, 56c680b)